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NOVEMBER 2026

The 2026 Arizona Talent Profile

Emerson Johnston
Amy Zegart

The bright caps, **41 in every 100**, mark the international share of Arizona's STEM master's degrees.



The 2026 Arizona Talent Profile

By Emerson Johnston and Amy Zegart

NOVEMBER 2026

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Table of Contents

OVERVIEW

At a Glance 6

SECTIONS

Section 1 International Dependence 8
Section 2 STEM Degrees 18
Section 3 Where Students Come From 24
Section 4 K-12 Preparation 30
Section 5 Graduate Research 32
Section 6 Do Graduates Stay? 34
Section 7 Research Funding 36
Section 8 H-1B Jobs and Green Cards 38
Section 9 STEM Workforce 42
Section 10 Patents 44
Section 11 Competitors 46
Section 12 Fields of Study 48
Section 13 Students and Money 58
Section 14 Student Outcomes 66
Section 15 Faculty 70
Section 16 Institutions 74

BACK MATTER

About these Data 78
By the Numbers 80
Sources 89

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Data come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), the Department of Homeland Security's SEVIS by the Numbers, the National Assessment of Educational Progress, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates and Survey of Earned Doctorates, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and USPTO patent data via PatentsView, processed in Python; every figure and table is generated from those sources, and each one names its source.

About This Profile

This profile is a companion to *The 2026 US Talent Report: Benchmarking America's STEM Pipeline Amid the Great Talent Competition*. It applies the report's measures to Arizona: the students the state develops at home, those it draws from abroad, and how both compare with the nation and with the states closest to it in size.

Degrees, enrollment, prices, outcomes and faculty come from IPEDS, the federal census of U.S. colleges and universities, harmonized across 1980–2025. Countries of citizenship come from SEVIS by the Numbers, the Department of Homeland Security's monthly count of active F-1 and M-1 students. Each figure names its source. Peer states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

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Public Data and Tools

The data behind every chart come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), published by the National Center for Education Statistics, and from SEVIS by the Numbers, published by the Department of Homeland Security's Student and Exchange Visitor Program. An interactive version of this profile accompanies the report.

To share any charts and figures, proper attribution is required. This profile is licensed under Attribution-NoDerivatives 4.0 International (CC BY-ND 4.0). Please cite as: The 2026 Arizona Talent Profile.

AT A GLANCE

What Arizona's numbers say

1. **International students earn 41% of Arizona's STEM master's degrees,** 11.3 points below the U.S. (52%) in 2025, ranking 27th of 51 on dependence. The share is 42% for STEM research doctorates (U.S. 43%) and 5.1% for STEM bachelor's (U.S. 6.6%).
2. **Arizona awarded 2.58K STEM master's degrees to international students in 2025,** 2.2% of the U.S. total and 15th of 51 among states. Since 2015 the count changed 2.2×, against 2.2× nationally.
3. **The heaviest dependence is in engineering technology,** where international students earned 70% of master's degrees (289 degrees; U.S. 54%). One STEM field with at least 50 master's graduates is majority-international.
4. **Among states of similar size,** Arizona ranks 5th of 5 on the international share of STEM master's: Arizona 41%, Illinois 66%, Pennsylvania 54%, Ohio 58%, Georgia 44%.
5. **61% of Arizona's first-time students in fall 2024 were state residents** and 2.3% came from abroad. More students arrived from other states (28.9K) than residents left (7.63K), a net gain of 21.2K; the top destination for those leaving was California.

41%

of the STEM master's degrees Arizona awards go to international students (U.S. 52%).

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SCORECARD

Nine numbers against the nation

684K #6
Students enrolled, 2024
U.S. **19.7M** · +5.2% since 2015

2.58K #15
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · 2.21× since 2015

41% #27
International share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · −5.1 pp since 2015

8.9% #41
International share of grad students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · +2.7 pp since 2015

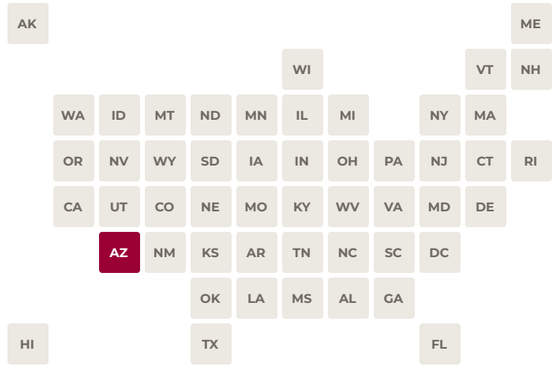
17% #47
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · +3.4 pp since 2015

58% #37
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · +7.6 pp since 2015

$9.12K #37
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · −3.6% since 2015

61% #38
First-time students from in state, 2024
U.S. **–** · −7.4 pp since 2016

$102K #18
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · −6.5% since 2016



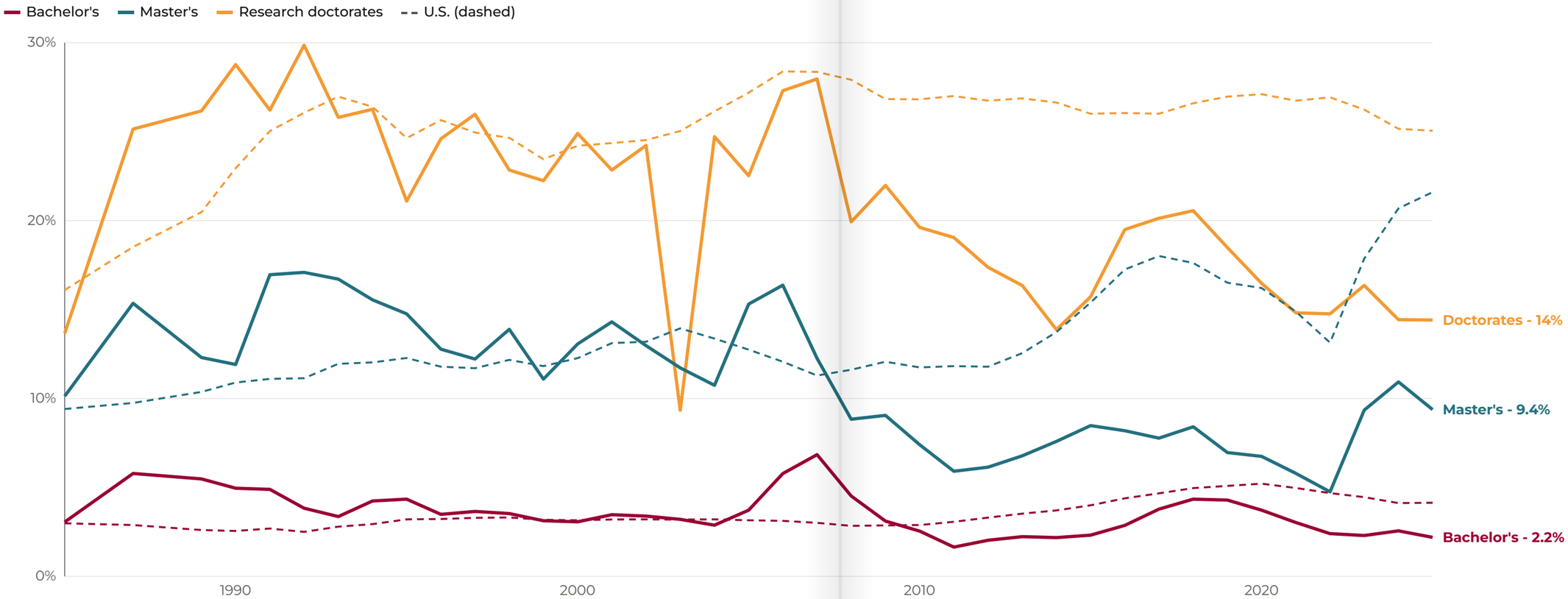
Badges give Arizona's rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Changes are since 2015.

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SECTION 1

International Dependence

Figure 1 What Share of Arizona's Degrees Go to International Students?



International share of degrees awarded, all fields; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions, 1985–2025.

International students make up 8.9% of Arizona's graduate enrollment and 1.8% of its undergraduates. Dependence climbs with each degree: 2.2% of bachelor's, 9.4% of master's and 14% of research doctorates go to international students.

In STEM the shares are higher still: 5.1% of STEM bachelor's, 41% of STEM master's and 42% of STEM doctorates. The state awards 2.2% of all U.S. international STEM master's, 15th of 51.

8.9%

Int. share of grad students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **41st** of 51 · +2.7 pp since 2015

9.4%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

U.S. **22%** · **39th** of 51 · +0.9 pp since 2015

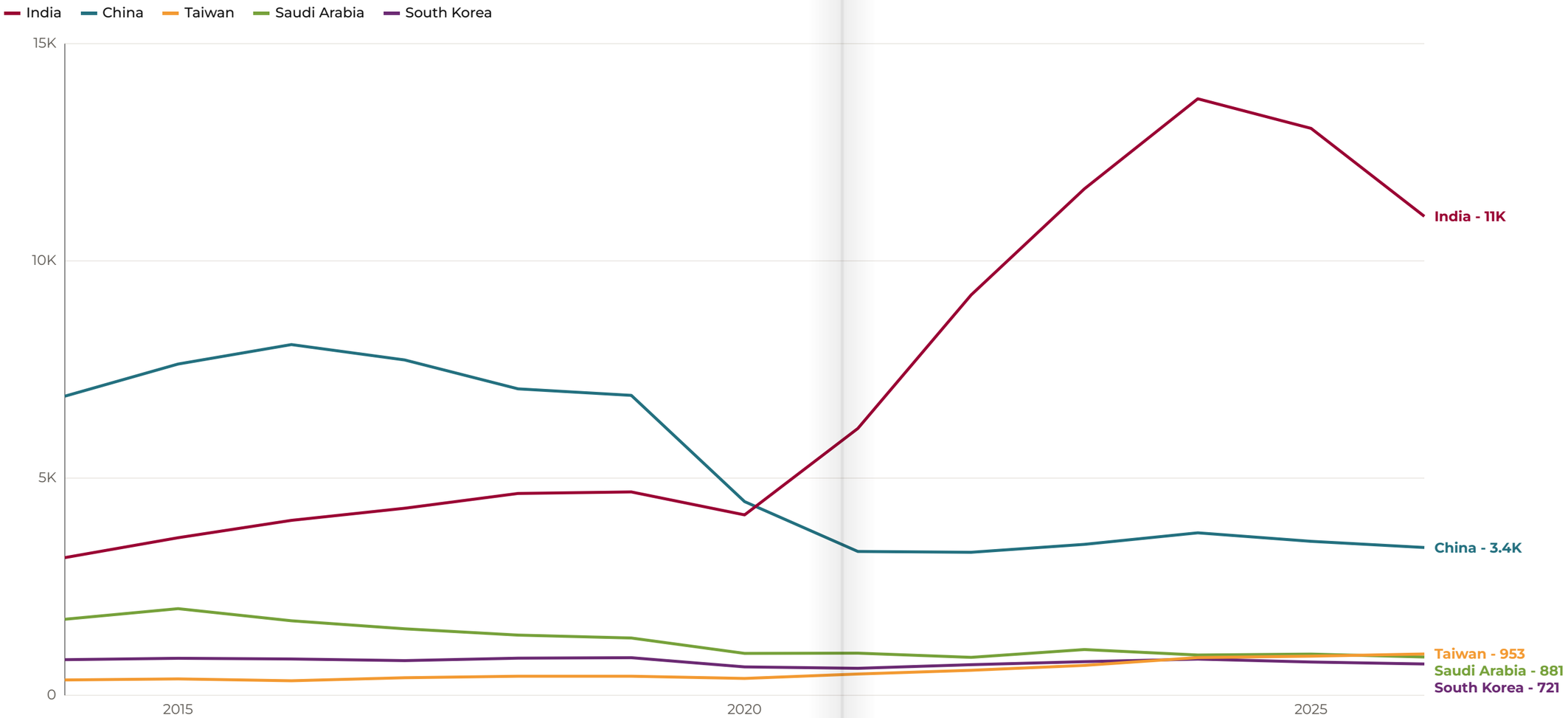
41%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **27th** of 51 · −5.1 pp since 2015

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Figure 2 Where Do Arizona's International Students Come From?



Active F-1 and M-1 students by country of citizenship, the five largest in October 2026; one snapshot per year (the latest month available), October 2014–October 2026. All education levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

In October 2026, Arizona had 26.5K active international students in SEVIS, 15th of 51. India accounted for 42% of them and China for 13%, against 27% and 18% nationally.

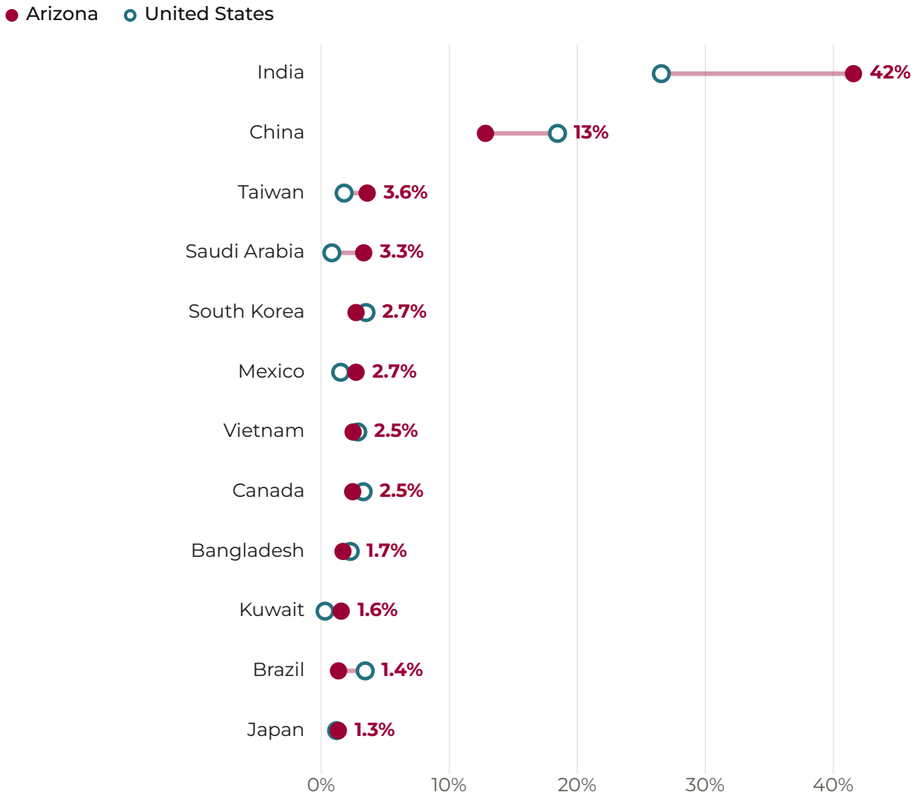
Students came from 169 countries, but the two largest supplied 54%. The state's total is up 38% since 2014.

26.5K
Active international students, October 2026
15th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

42%
From India
U.S. **27%**

61%
In STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

Figure 3 Is Arizona's Mix of Countries Like the Nation's?



Share of active F-1 and M-1 students, all levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

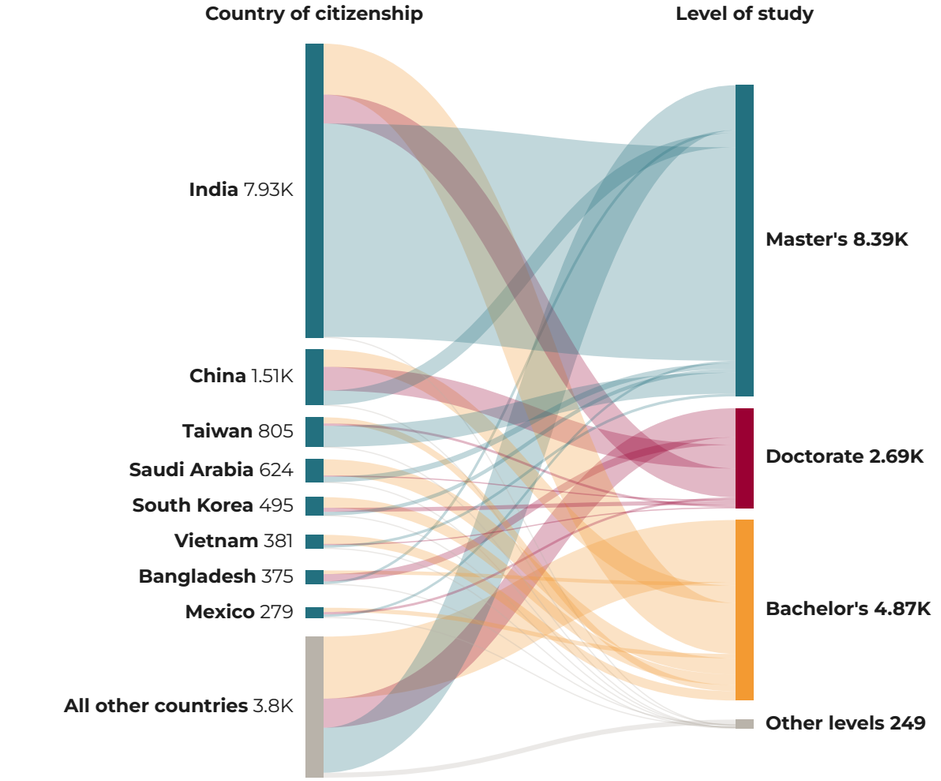
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each row is one of the 12 countries with the most active F-1 and M-1 student records in Arizona in October 2026. The filled dot is the country's share of the state's international students; the open dot is its share of all international students in the United States. Students at every level, from secondary school to doctorate, are counted. Yearly counts are the latest month available in each year.

THE NUMBERS

- **All active international students**: 26.5K in October 2026, 15th of 51 states (U.S. 1.19M), down 8.4% from 29K in 2025, and up 27% since 2015 (20.8K).
- **India**: 42% of the state's international students (U.S. 27%); 11K students in 2026, down 16% from 13.1K in 2025, and up 204% since 2015 (3.63K).
- **China**: 13% of the state's international students (U.S. 18%); 3.4K students in 2026, down 4.0% from 3.55K in 2025, and down 55% since 2015 (7.63K).
- **Taiwan**: 3.6% of the state's international students (U.S. 1.8%); 953 students in 2026, up 5.8% from 901 in 2025, and up 153% since 2015 (377).

Figure 4 Which Countries Supply Arizona's International STEM Students?



Active F-1 and M-1 students in STEM fields by country of citizenship and level, October 2026; the eight largest countries. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

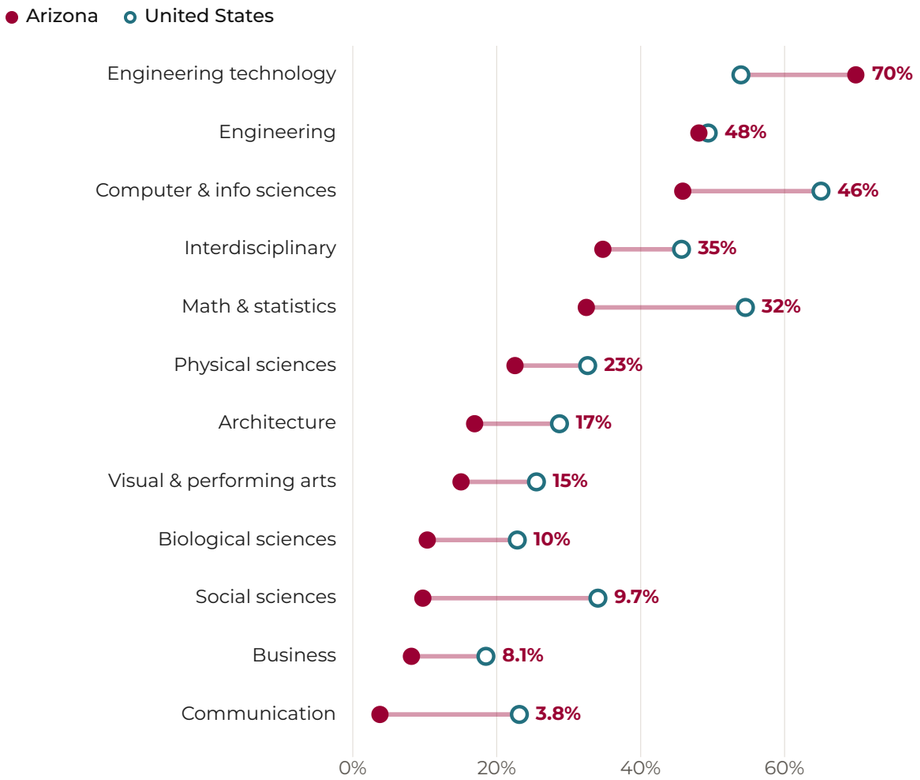
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each band runs from a country of citizenship on the left to a level of study on the right, for international students enrolled in STEM fields in October 2026. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. The eight largest countries are shown and the rest are grouped as all other countries.

THE NUMBERS

- **Share of international students in STEM fields**: 61% in October 2026 (U.S. 63%).
- **Master's level**: 8.39K students; largest countries India (5.75K), Taiwan (571), China (391).
- **Doctorate level**: 2.69K students; largest countries India (779), China (641), Bangladesh (198).
- **Bachelor's level**: 4.87K students; largest countries India (1.37K), China (466), Saudi Arabia (438).
- **Active STEM students**: 16.2K in 2026 (U.S. 749K; 16th of 51 states), down 9.9% from 18K in 2025, and up 84% since 2015 (8.82K).
- **Share of STEM master's students from India**: 69% in 2026 (U.S. 58%; 8th of 51 states), down 5.6 points from 74% in 2025, and down 7.4 points since 2015 (76%).

Figure 5 Which Master's Fields Depend Most on International Students?



International share of master's degrees by field, 2025; fields with 30+ graduates. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each row is a master's field with at least 30 graduates in Arizona in 2025, ranked by the share of degrees earned by international students (U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas). The filled dot is the state's share; the open dot is the national share for the same field.

THE NUMBERS

- **Highest international shares**: engineering technology 70% (U.S. 54%); engineering 48% (U.S. 49%); computer & info sciences 46% (U.S. 65%).
- **All master's degrees**: 9.4% in 2025 (U.S. 22%; 39th of 51 states), down 1.6 points from 11% in 2024, and up 0.9 points since 2015 (8.5%).
- **STEM master's degrees**: 41% in 2025 (U.S. 52%; 27th of 51 states), down 7.2 points from 48% in 2024, and down 5.1 points since 2015 (46%).
- **Computer and information sciences master's**: 46% in 2025 (U.S. 65%; 34th of 47 states), down 3.1 points from 49% in 2024, and up 1.0 point since 2015 (45%).

Table 1 How International Is Each STEM Field?

Field	Bachelor's	Master's	Doctorates
Computer & info sciences	7.2% / 8.6%	**46% / 65%**	55% / 56%
Engineering	7.2% / 7.2%	**48% / 49%**	59% / 55%
Engineering technology	2.7% / 4.5%	**70% / 54%**	– / 42%
Math & statistics	11% / 17%	**32% / 55%**	37% / 53%
Physical sciences	5.9% / 6.0%	**23% / 33%**	33% / 38%
Biological sciences	1.9% / 3.4%	**10% / 23%**	21% / 23%
Natural resources	0.5% / 2.0%	**3.4% / 17%**	37% / 27%
Architecture	6.1% / 7.3%	**17% / 29%**	– / 55%

International share in Arizona / U.S., 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

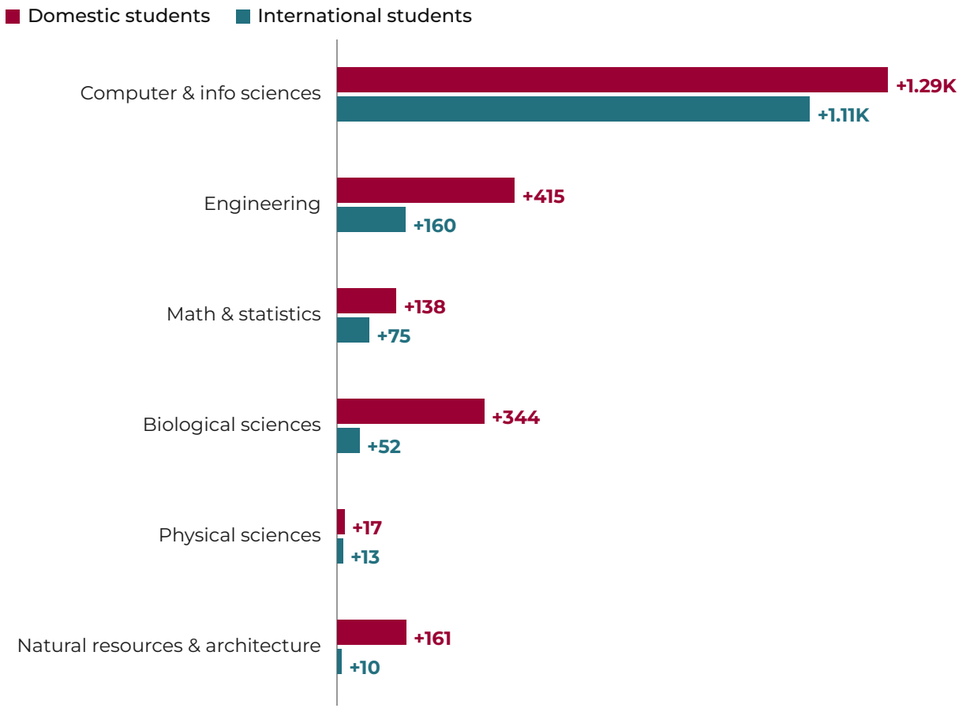
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The table gives the international share of degrees in each STEM field at three levels: Arizona first, the United States after the slash. The master's column is highlighted. A dash means the state awarded no degrees in the field at that level.

THE NUMBERS

- **Highest international share among STEM master's fields**: engineering technology, 70% (U.S. 54%).
- **STEM fields where international students earn a majority of master's degrees**: 1.
- **International share of STEM bachelor's**: 5.1% in 2025 (U.S. 6.6%; 24th of 51 states), down 1.2 points from 6.3% in 2024, and up 1.0 point since 2015 (4.1%).
- **International share of STEM master's**: 41% in 2025 (U.S. 52%; 27th of 51 states), down 7.2 points from 48% in 2024, and down 5.1 points since 2015 (46%).
- **International share of STEM research doctorates**: 42% in 2025 (U.S. 43%; 25th of 51 states), up 0.8 points from 42% in 2024, and down 2.9 points since 2015 (45%).

Figure 6 Where Did the STEM Master's Growth Come From?



Change in STEM master's degrees by field, 2015–2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each pair of bars is the change in the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in Arizona between 2015 and 2025 in one field: to domestic students (U.S. citizens and permanent residents) and to international students. Bars to the left of the axis are declines.

THE NUMBERS

- **STEM master's degrees**: 6.32K in 2025, against 2.54K in 2015: +1.42K for international students and +2.36K for domestic students.
- **Computer & info sciences**: +1.29K for domestic students and +1.11K for international students.
- **Engineering**: +415 for domestic students and +160 for international students.
- **Math & statistics**: +138 for domestic students and +75 for international students.
- **International students' STEM master's degrees**: 2.58K in 2025 (U.S. 117K; 15th of 51 states), down 19% from 3.21K in 2024, and up 121% since 2015 (1.17K).

Table 2 How Many STEM Master's Degrees Does Each Field Award?

Field	2015	2025	Change	International 2025	Int. share 2015	Int. share 2025
Computer & info sciences	763	**3.16K**	+314%	1.45K	45%	46%
Engineering	1.18K	**1.75K**	+49%	907	63%	52%
Math & statistics	52	**265**	+410%	86	21%	32%
Biological sciences	203	**599**	+195%	62	4.9%	10%
Physical sciences	112	**142**	+27%	32	17%	23%
Natural resources & architecture	232	**403**	+74%	48	16%	12%

STEM master's degrees awarded in Arizona, all students and international students, 2015 and 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The table gives the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in Arizona in each field in 2015 and 2025, the change between the two years, the number awarded to international students in 2025, and international students' share of the field's degrees in each year.

THE NUMBERS

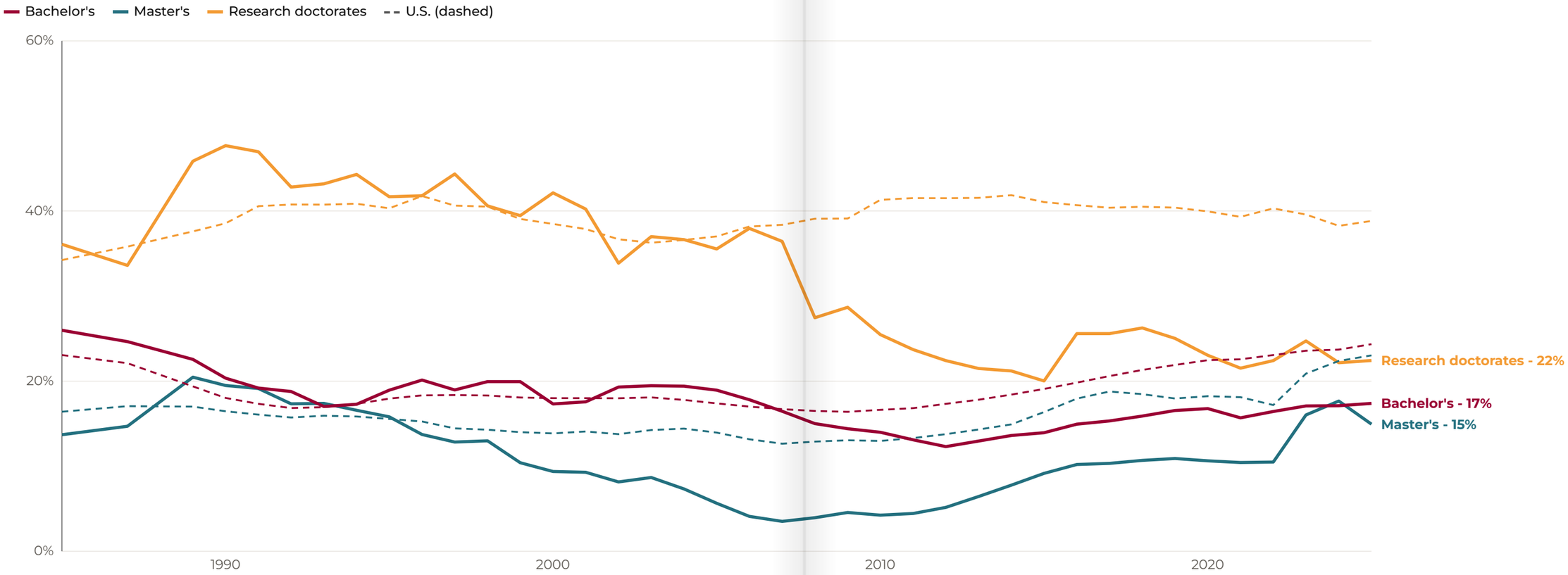
- **STEM share of master's degrees**: 15% in 2025 (U.S. 23%; 42nd of 51 states), down 2.7 points from 18% in 2024, and up 5.8 points since 2015 (9.1%).
- **Share of all U.S. international STEM master's**: 2.2% in 2025 (15th of 51 states), down 0.7 points from 2.9% in 2024, and unchanged since 2015 (2.2%).
- **STEM master's degrees per research doctorate**: 10.1 in 2025 (U.S. 6.4; 5th of 51 states), down 1.2 from 11.3 in 2024, and up 5.0 since 2015 (5.1).

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SECTION 2

STEM Degrees

Figure 7 How Much of Arizona's Degree Output Is STEM?



STEM share of degrees by level; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

STEM fields account for 17% of Arizona's bachelor's degrees, 15% of its master's and 22% of its research doctorates (U.S. 24%, 23% and 39%).

The STEM share of master's degrees is up 5.8 points since 2015, and the state ranks 42nd of 51 on it. On the STEM share of bachelor's degrees it ranks 47th of 51.

17%

STEM share of bachelor's, 2025

U.S. **24%** · **47th** of 51 · +3.4 pp since 2015

15%

STEM share of master's, 2025

U.S. **23%** · **42nd** of 51 · +5.8 pp since 2015

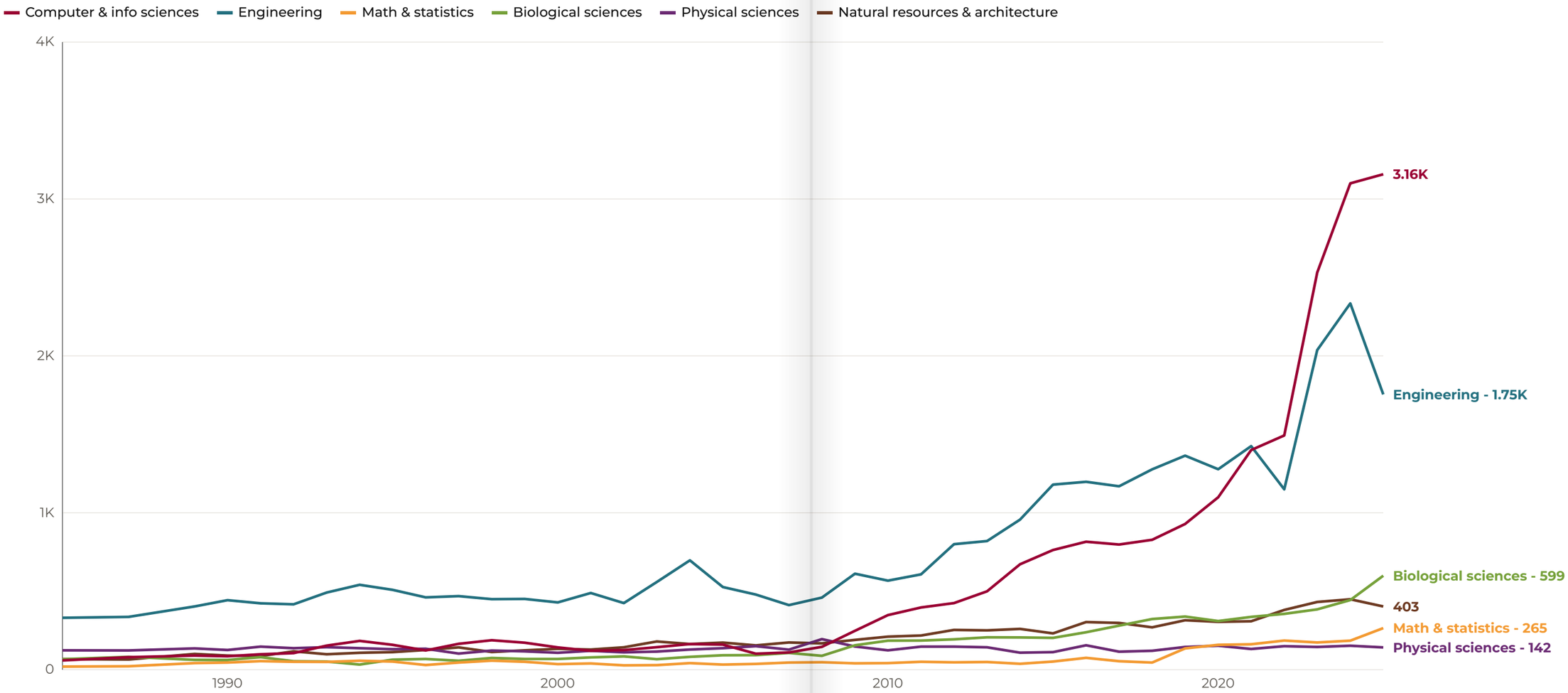
22%

STEM share of research doctorates, 2025

U.S. **39%** · **48th** of 51 · +2.4 pp since 2015

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Figure 8 Which STEM Fields Produce Arizona's Master's Degrees?



STEM master's degrees by field, all students. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Computer & info sciences produced the most STEM master's degrees in 2025, 3.16K, followed by engineering (1.75K) and biological sciences (599). Master's degrees in computer & info sciences are up 314% since 2015.

International students earned 2.58K of the state's STEM master's degrees in 2025, 2.2% of the national total (15th of 51).

2.58K

International STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **117K** · **15th** of 51 · 2.21× since 2015

2.2%

Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **100%** · **15th** of 51 · 0.0 pp since 2015

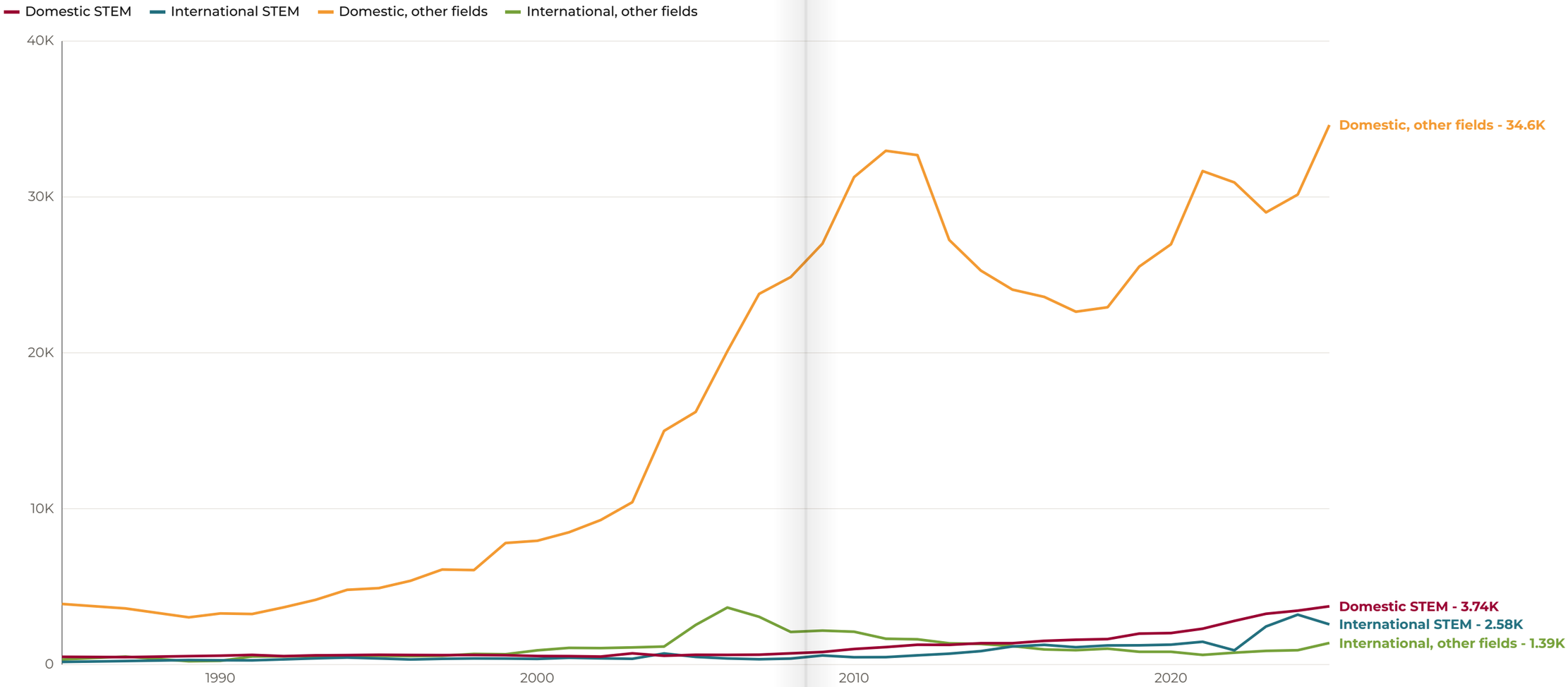
46%

Int. share of CS master's, 2025

U.S. **65%** · **34th** of 47 · +1.0 pp since 2015

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Figure 9 Who Earns Arizona's Master's Degrees?



Master's degrees by student residency and field group. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Between 2015 and 2025, 1.42K more STEM master's degrees went to international students and 2.36K more to domestic students.

International students earn 41% of Arizona's STEM master's but 3.8% of master's in other fields (U.S. 52% and 12%).

9.4%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

U.S. **22%** · **39th** of 51 · +0.9 pp since 2015

41%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **27th** of 51 · −5.1 pp since 2015

10.1

STEM master's per doctorate, 2025

U.S. **6.4** · **5th** of 51 · +5.0 since 2015

SECTION 3

Where Students Come From

Figure 10 First-Time Students by Home and Destination, Fall 2024



Home of first-time degree-seeking undergraduates (left) and the state of the institution entered (right); the five largest sources and destinations, the rest grouped. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

49.2K residents stayed in Arizona for college in fall 2024; 28.9K students arrived from other states and 1.88K from abroad, while 7.63K residents left.

Each band runs from a student's home on the left to the state where they enrolled on the right. 61% of the state's first-time students are residents (U.S. –).

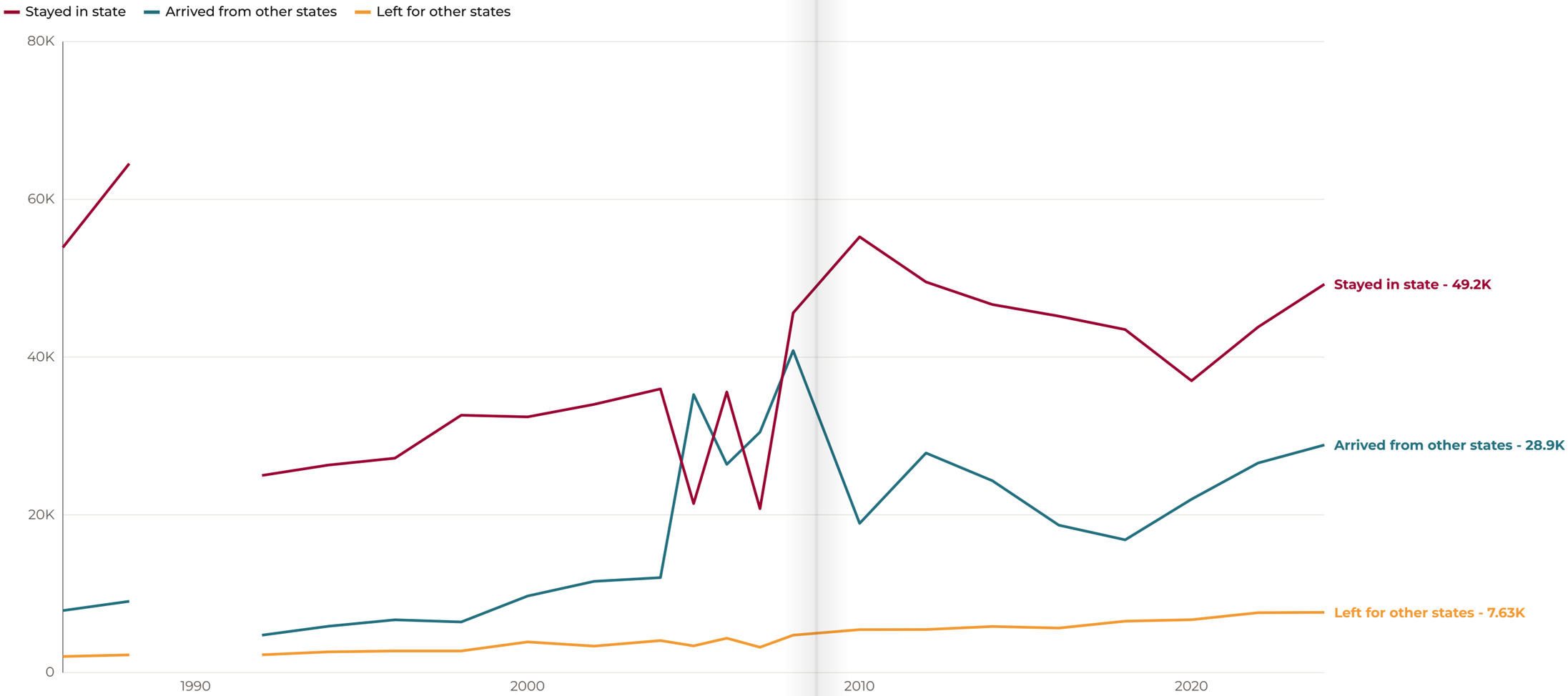
61%
First-time students from in state, 2024
· **38th** of 51 · −7.4 pp since 2016

2.3%
First-time students from abroad, 2024
U.S. **3.1%** · **30th** of 51 · +0.1 pp since 2016

+37
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024
· **6th** of 51 · +11.6 since 2016

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Figure 11 How Have the Flows Changed?

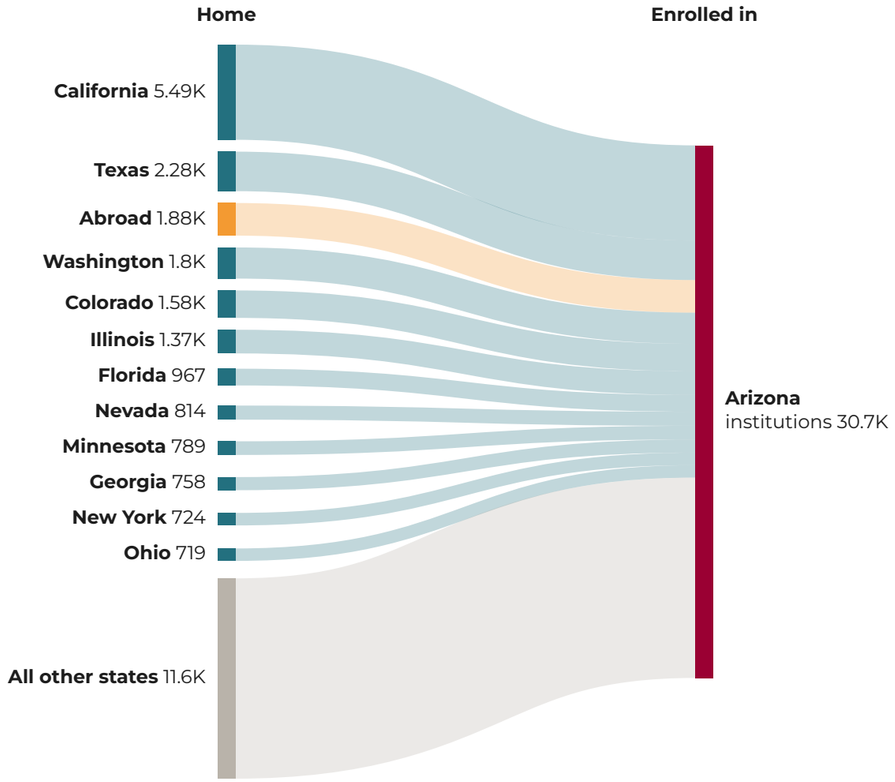


First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by flow; even years before 2001. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Since 2015, the number of residents staying in state for college is up 9%, arrivals from other states are up 54%, and residents leaving are up 35%.

Net migration was +37 per 100 resident first-time students (6th of 51). The top destination for residents who left was California (930).

Figure 12 Where Do Arizona's Newcomers Come From?



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

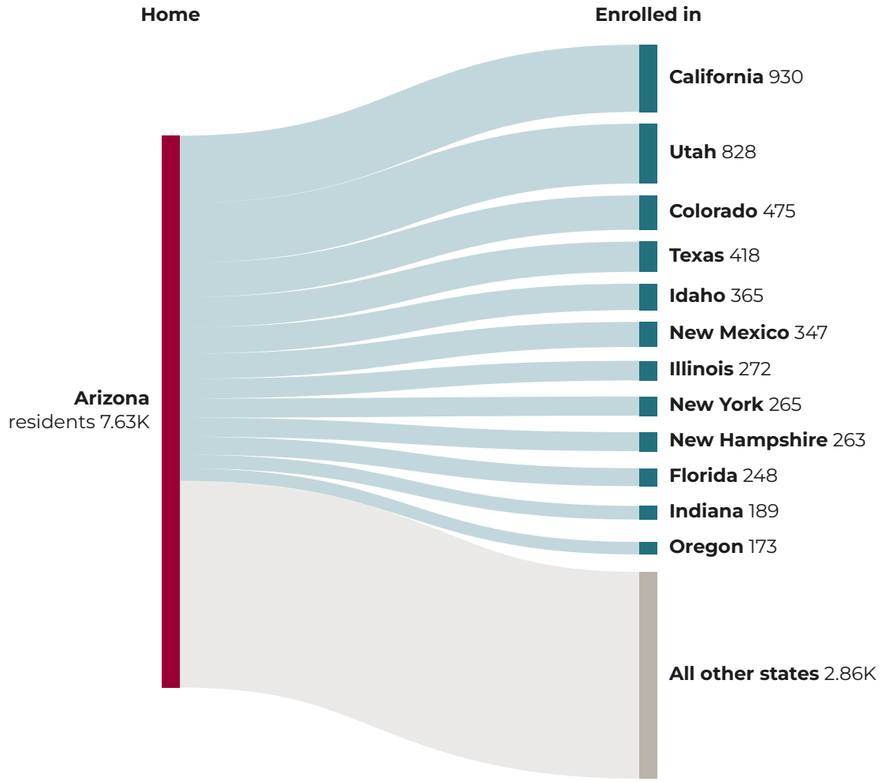
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The bands show where first-time degree-seeking undergraduates who enrolled at Arizona's institutions in fall 2024 but did not live in the state came from: the 12 largest home states and students from abroad, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Home is the state where the student lived when admitted.

THE NUMBERS

- **Students arriving from other states**: 28.9K in fall 2024, up 8.6% from 26.6K in fall 2022, and up 54% since fall 2016 (18.7K).
- **Students arriving from abroad**: 1.88K in fall 2024.
- **Largest home states**: California (5.49K), Texas (2.28K), Washington (1.8K).
- **Share of first-time students from outside the U.S.**: 2.3% in 2024 (U.S. 3.1%; 30th of 51 states), down 0.1 points from 2.4% in 2022, and up 0.1 points since 2016 (2.3%).

Figure 13 Where Do Arizona's Residents Go When They Leave?



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The bands show where Arizona residents who left the state to start college in fall 2024 enrolled: the 12 largest destination states, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Residents who enrolled in the state are not shown.

THE NUMBERS

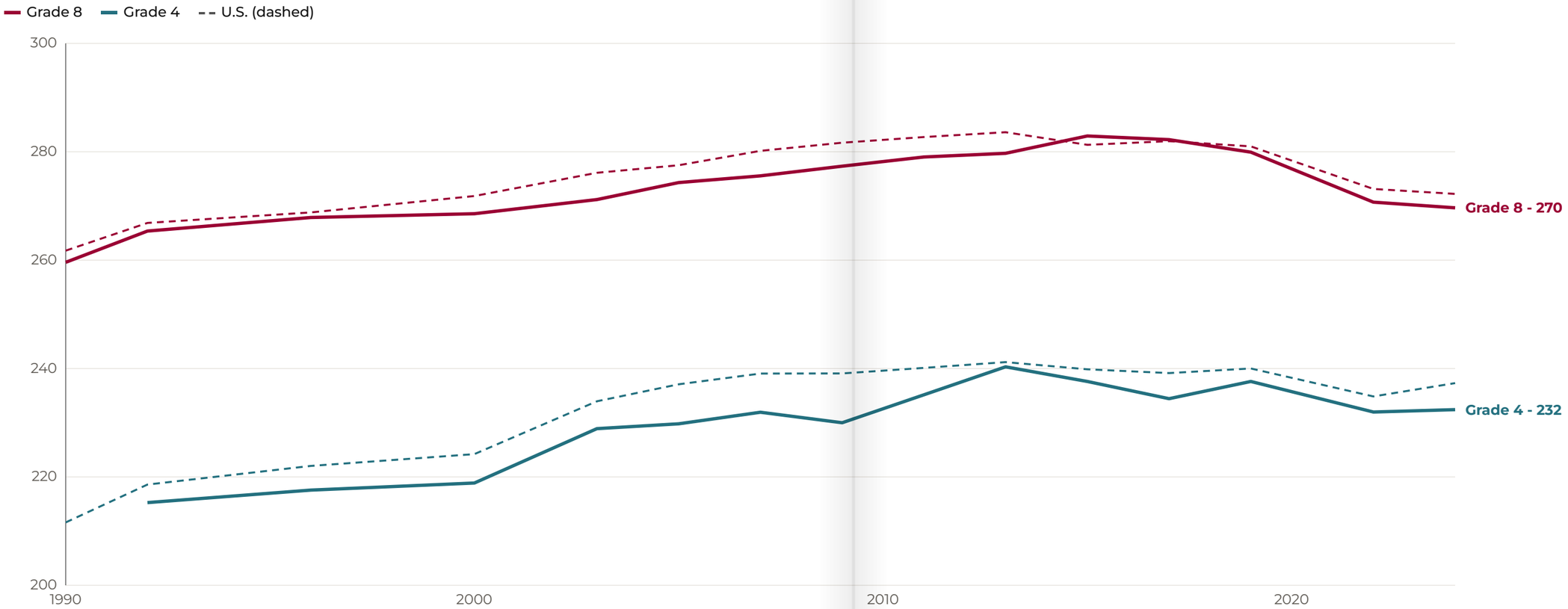
- **Residents leaving for other states**: 7.63K in fall 2024, up 0.5% from 7.59K in fall 2022, and up 35% since fall 2016 (5.64K).
- **Residents staying in the state**: 49.2K in fall 2024, up 12% from 43.8K in fall 2022, and up 9.0% since fall 2016 (45.2K).
- **Largest destinations**: California (930), Utah (828), Colorado (475).
- **Net migration per 100 resident first-time students**: +37 in 2024 (6th of 51 states), up 0 from +37 in 2022, and up 12 since 2016 (+26).
- **Share of first-time students who are residents**: 61% in 2024 (38th of 51 states), up 0.8 points from 60% in 2022, and down 7.4 points since 2016 (69%).

ARIZONA · STATE TALENT PROFILE

SECTION 4

K-12 Preparation

Figure 14 How Well Prepared in Mathematics Are Arizona's Students?



Average NAEP mathematics score, public schools, 0–500 scale; state solid, U.S. public schools dashed. Data from NCES, National Assessment of Educational Progress.

The talent pipeline starts in school. Arizona's eighth graders averaged 270 in mathematics on the 2024 NAEP, against 272 for U.S. public schools, 33rd of 51 among the states.

26% scored at or above the Proficient level (U.S. 27%). Differences of a point or two are often within the margin of error.

270

Grade 8 math score (NAEP), 2024

U.S. **272** · **33rd** of 51 · −13.3 since 2015

26%

Grade 8 math, at or above Proficient, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **28th** of 51 · −9.0 pp since 2015

254

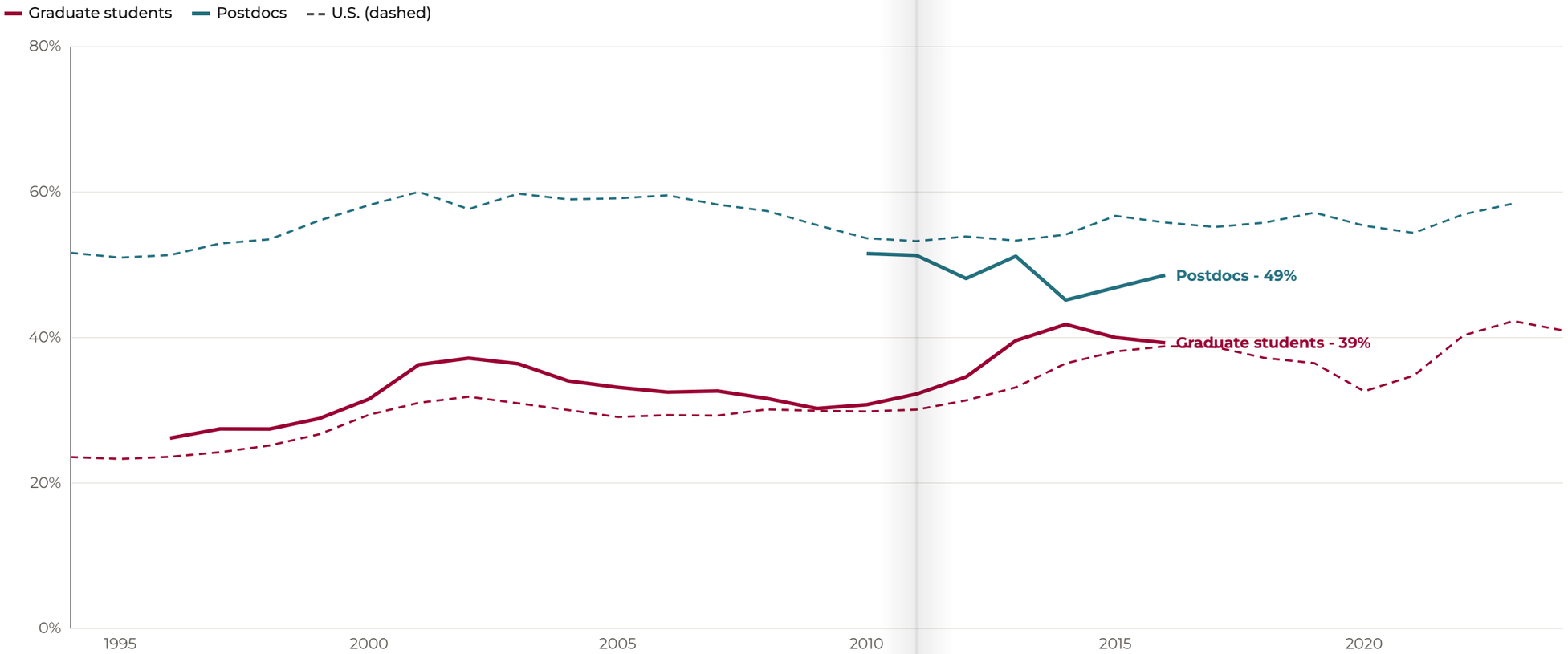
Grade 8 reading score (NAEP), 2024

U.S. **257** · **39th** of 51 · −8.4 since 2015

SECTION 5

Graduate Research

Figure 15 How Many of Arizona's Science and Engineering Graduate Students Hold Temporary Visas?



Temporary-visa share of science and engineering graduate students and postdoctoral appointees, by the institution's state; state solid, U.S. dashed. NSF stopped publishing state tables after 2016. Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates.

In 2016, the last year NSF published state tables, 39% of Arizona's science and engineering graduate students held temporary visas (U.S. 39%; 16th of 51).

Among postdoctoral researchers, the share was 49% (U.S. 56%). Postdocs are the stage of research training most dependent on international talent, and IPEDS does not count them.

The state's institutions awarded 1.07K research doctorates in 2025, 1.8% of the U.S. total (Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Earned Doctorates; NSF publishes doctorates by citizenship only for the nation).

39%

S&E grad students on temporary visas, 2016

U.S. **39%** · **16th** of 51 · −0.7 pp since 2015

49%

S&E postdocs on temporary visas, 2016

U.S. **56%** · **34th** of 51 · +1.7 pp since 2015

1.07K

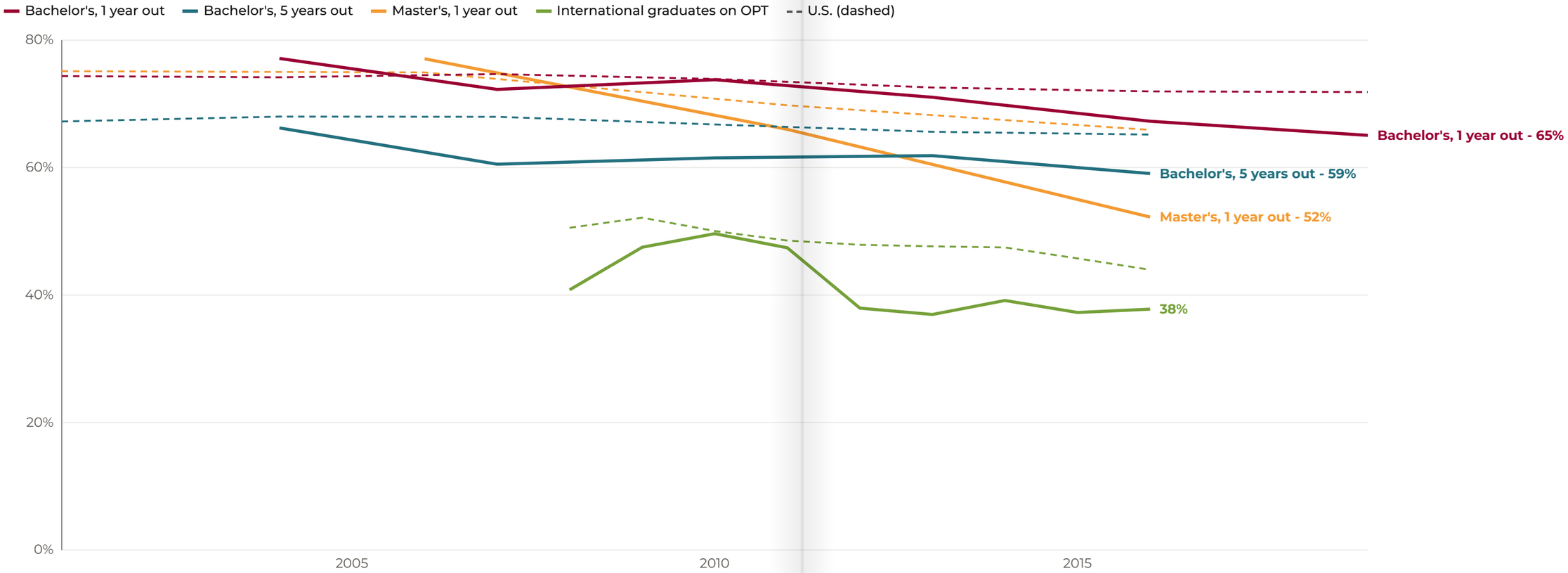
Research doctorates awarded (NSF SED), 2025

U.S. **59K** · **19th** of 51 · +8.4% since 2015

SECTION 6

Do Graduates Stay?

Figure 16 How Many of Arizona's Graduates Go On to Work in the State?



Share of employed graduates working in the state of their institution, by graduating cohort (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes; participating institutions only); international graduates' OPT jobs in the state where they studied (Data from ICE, SEVIS FOIA releases; shares only, the file is truncated). State solid, U.S. or participating states dashed.

Of Arizona's bachelor's graduates who were working a year after graduating, 65% worked in the state (participating states 72%). Five years out the share was 59%.

Among international graduates on Optional Practical Training in 2016, 38% worked in the state where they studied (U.S. 44%). Through migration between states, the state gained 8.3 bachelor's-plus adults per 1,000 such residents in 2025 (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey).

65%

Bachelor's grads working in-state, 1 year out, 2019

U.S. **72%** · **19th** of 33 · −2.2 pp since 2016

38%

OPT graduates working in the state, 2016

U.S. **44%** · **21st** of 51 · +0.5 pp since 2015

+8.3

Net migration, bachelor's-plus, per 1,000, 2025

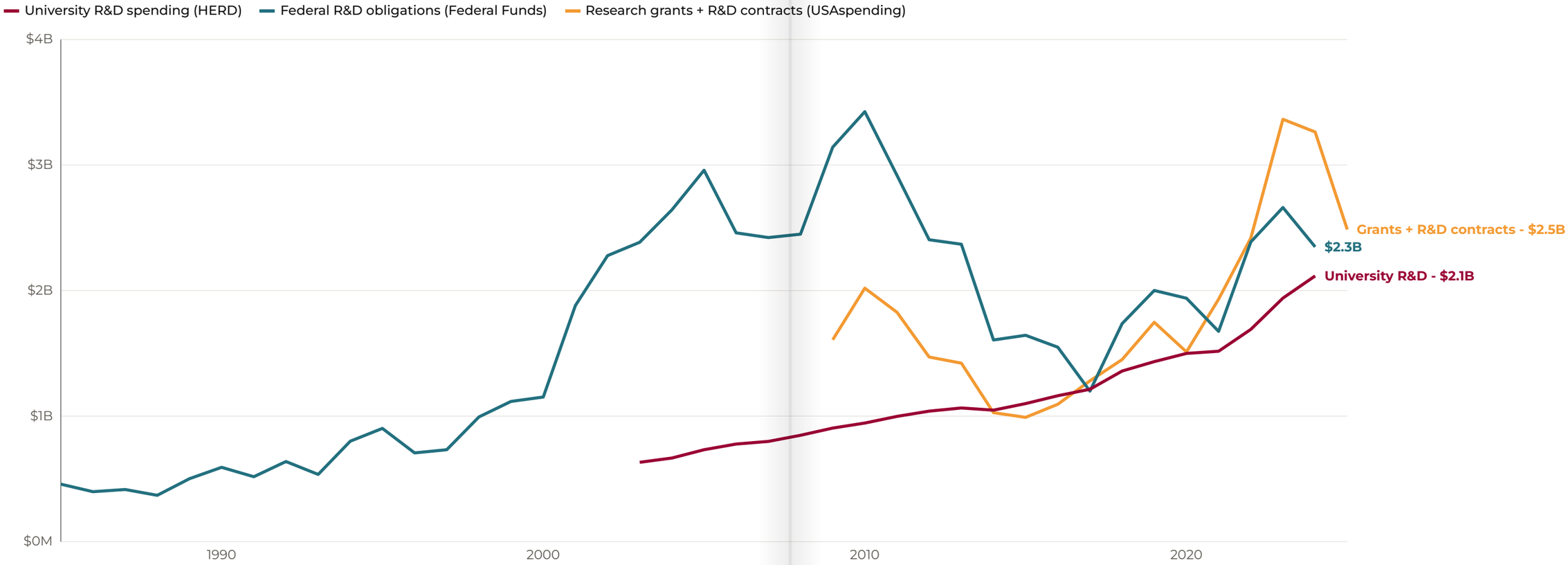
· **7th** of 51 · −5.7 since 2015

ARIZONA · STATE TALENT PROFILE

SECTION 7

Research Funding

Figure 17 How Much Research Money Flows Into Arizona?



Millions of nominal dollars, fiscal years. University R&D: Data from NSF NCSES, Higher Education Research and Development Survey (FY2003-09 predecessor survey). Federal R&D obligations by state of performance: Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Federal Funds for R&D (coverage widens in FY2021). Grants from NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science plus R&D contracts: Data from USAspending.gov.

Arizona's universities spent $2.12B on research and development in FY2024, 19th of 51 among the states; 44% of it was federally funded (U.S. 55%).

Federal agencies obligated $2.35B for R&D performed in the state in FY2024. Research funding drives demand for graduate students and postdocs, the stage of training most dependent on international talent.

$2.12B

University R&D spending, 2024

U.S. **$118B** · **19th** of 51 · +92% since 2015

44%

Federal share of university R&D, 2024

U.S. **55%** · **45th** of 51 · −0.1 pp since 2015

$2.35B

Federal R&D obligations, 2024

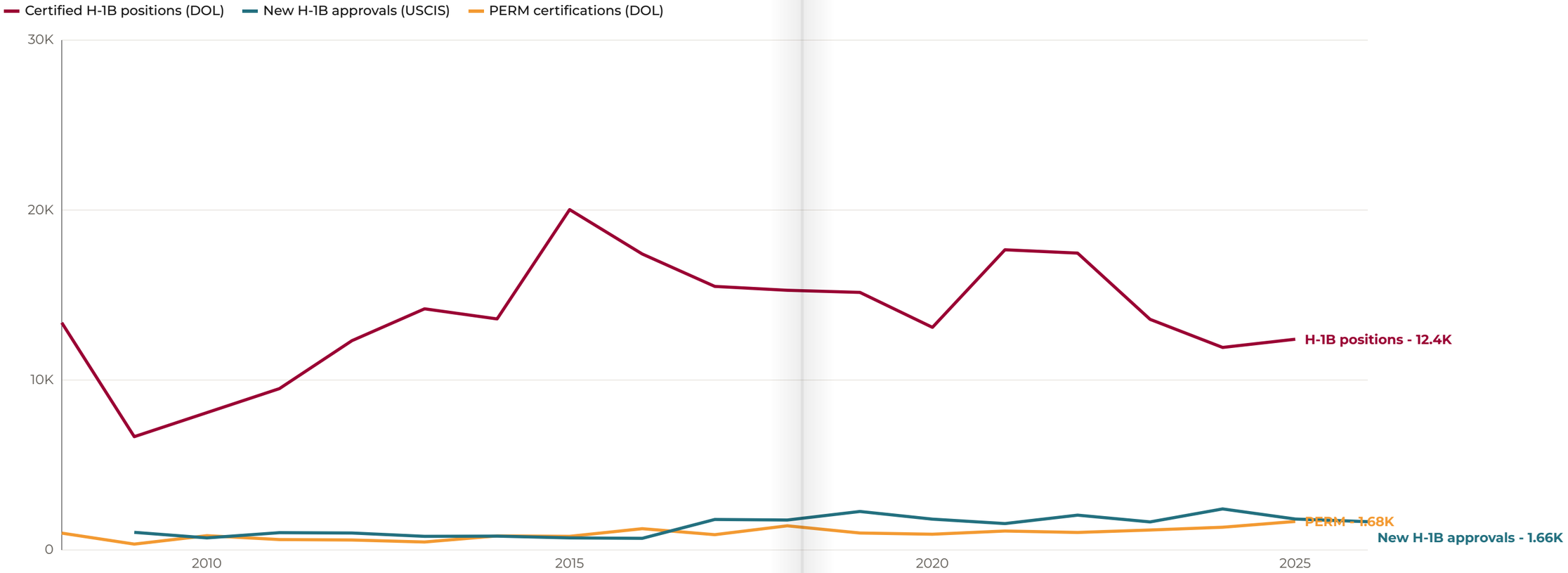
U.S. **$193B** · **23rd** of 51 · +43% since 2015

ARIZONA · STATE TALENT PROFILE

SECTION 8

H-1B Jobs and Green Cards

Figure 18 How Many Skilled-Visa Jobs and Green-Card Certifications Does Arizona Generate?



Certified H-1B positions on labor condition applications by worksite and certified PERM green-card applications, by fiscal year (Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification); new H-1B petition approvals by the employer's address (Data from USCIS, H-1B Employer Data Hub).

Employers were certified for 12.4K H-1B positions at Arizona worksites in FY2025, 15th of 51 among the states. A labor certification comes before the petition, so this overstates hires; USCIS approved 1.66K new H-1B petitions from employers in the state in FY2026.

DOL certified 1.68K PERM applications, the employer's step toward an employment-based green card, for jobs in the state in FY2025. In FY2024, 11% were for workers still on F-1 student visas (U.S. 8.7%): the most direct link from classroom to permanent residence.

12.4K

Certified H-1B positions (worksite), 2025

U.S. **914K** · **15th** of 51 · −38% since 2015

1.68K

PERM green-card certifications, 2025

U.S. **138K** · **18th** of 51 · 2.08× since 2015

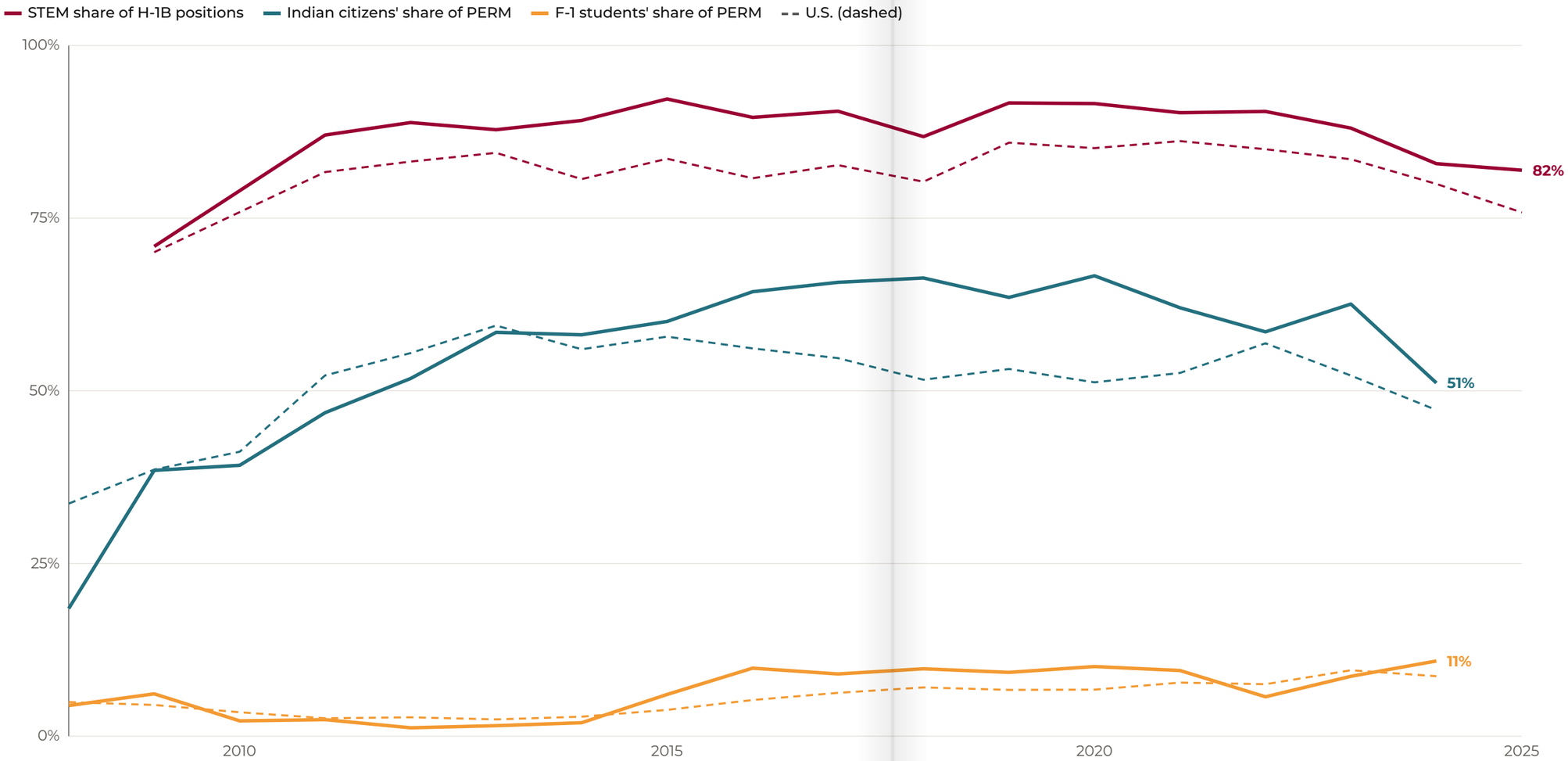
11%

PERM workers on F-1 student visas, 2024

U.S. **8.7%** · **21st** of 51 · +4.8 pp since 2015

ARIZONA · STATE TALENT PROFILE

Figure 19 Who Holds Arizona's Skilled-Visa Jobs?



State solid, U.S. dashed. PERM citizenship and class of admission are not on the form DOL uses from FY2025. Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification.

82% of the state's certified H-1B positions were in STEM occupations in FY2025 (U.S. 76%).

Citizens of India held 51% of the state's PERM certifications in FY2024 (U.S. 47%). Under per-country caps they face the longest waits for a green card, so this share measures the state's exposure to the backlog.

82%

STEM share of H-1B positions, 2025

U.S. **76%** · **9th** of 51 · −10.3 pp since 2015

51%

PERM certifications for Indian citizens, 2024

U.S. **47%** · **11th** of 51 · −8.9 pp since 2015

$106K

Median offered H-1B wage (nominal), 2025

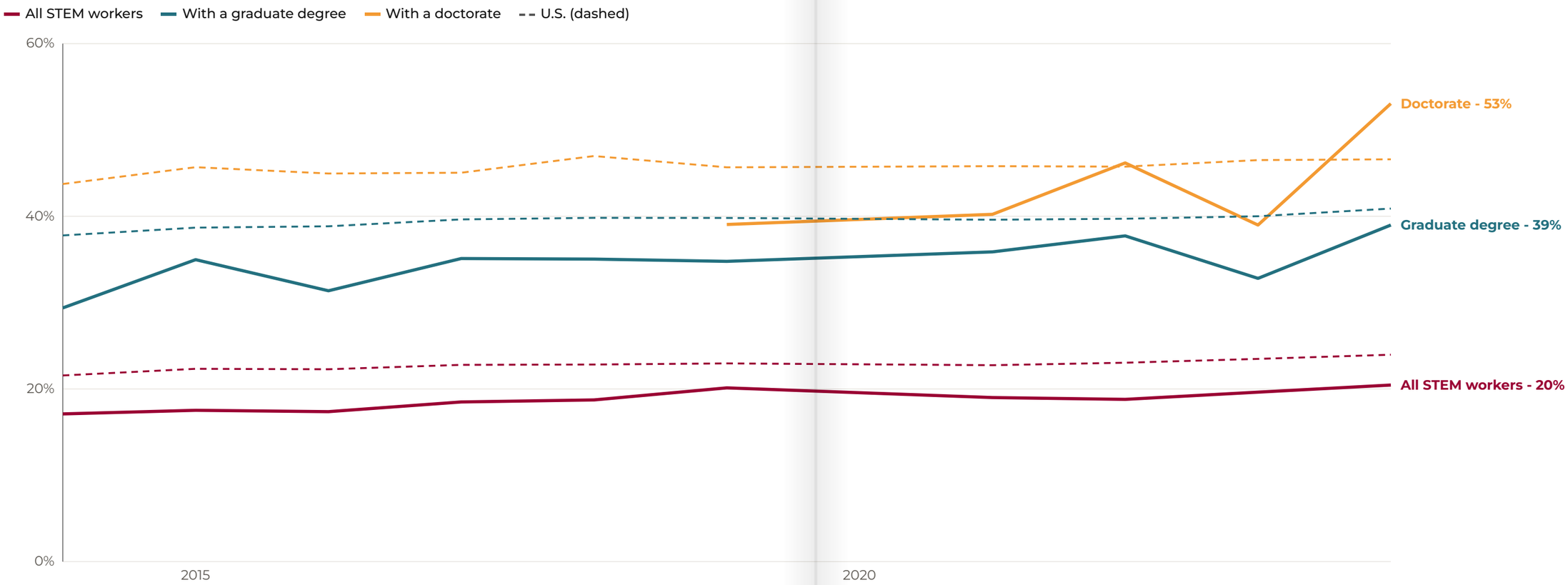
U.S. **$119K** · **21st** of 51 · +50% since 2015

ARIZONA · STATE TALENT PROFILE

SECTION 9

STEM Workforce

Figure 20 How Much of Arizona's STEM Workforce Was Born Abroad?



Foreign-born share of employed workers in STEM occupations, by state of residence; state solid, U.S. dashed. Shares resting on fewer than 100 survey records are left out. No 2020 (experimental data). Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey.

In 2024, 20% of the people working in STEM occupations in Arizona were born abroad (U.S. 24%; 14th of 51).

The share rises with education: 39% of STEM workers with a graduate degree were foreign-born (U.S. 41%). 9.7% of all STEM workers were not U.S. citizens.

20%

Foreign-born share of STEM workers, 2024

U.S. **24%** · **14th** of 51 · +2.9 pp since 2015

39%

Foreign-born, STEM workers with grad degrees, 2024

U.S. **41%** · **11th** of 44 · +4.0 pp since 2015

9.7%

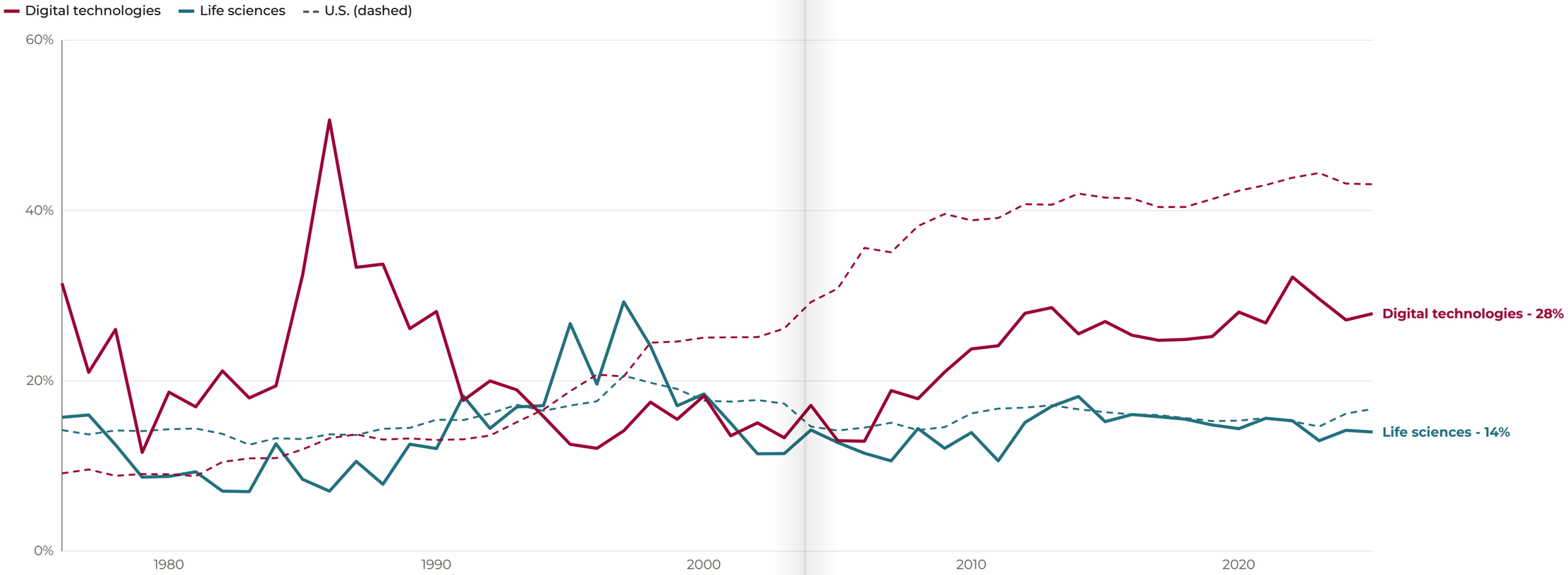
Noncitizen share of STEM workers, 2024

U.S. **11%** · **13th** of 51 · +0.4 pp since 2015

SECTION 10

Patents

Figure 21 What Kinds of Technology Does Arizona Patent?



Share of patents granted to owners in the state, by WIPO technology field of the first classification; state solid, U.S. dashed. Fractional counts by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live. Data from USPTO, PatentsView.

Organizations and people in Arizona were granted 1.78K U.S. patents in 2025, 1.3% of all patents with a U.S. owner (20th of 51).

28% were in digital technologies (U.S. 43%) and 14% in the life sciences (U.S. 17%).

1.78K

Patents granted to owners in the state, 2025

U.S. **135K** · **20th** of 51 · +49% since 2015

28%

Patents in digital technologies, 2025

U.S. **43%** · **18th** of 51 · +0.9 pp since 2015

14%

Patents in life sciences, 2025

U.S. **17%** · **33rd** of 51 · −1.2 pp since 2015

SECTION 11

Competitors

The four states closest in size are Illinois, Pennsylvania, Ohio, Georgia. Arizona ranks 5th of the five on the international share of STEM master's; Illinois is the most dependent at 66%.

Figure 22 How Dependent Are Arizona and Its Peers on International STEM Master's?

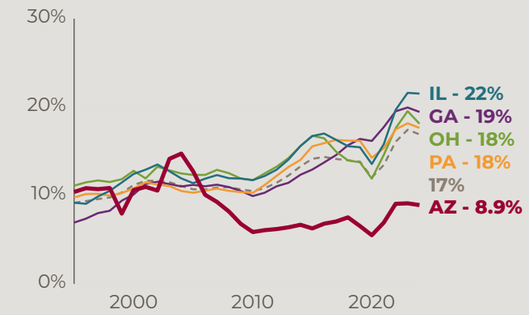
Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Table 3 How Does Arizona Compare With States of Similar Size?

Measure	AZ	IL	PA	OH	GA	U.S.
Students enrolled	**684K**	723K	637K	611K	594K	19.7M
Graduate share of students	**18%**	22%	23%	14%	18%	17%
STEM share of bachelor's	**17%**	23%	27%	24%	27%	24%
STEM share of master's	**15%**	23%	25%	27%	28%	23%
International STEM master's	**2.58K**	7.39K	5.51K	3.84K	3.78K	117K
Share of U.S. international STEM master's	**2.2%**	6.3%	4.7%	3.3%	3.2%	100%
Int. share of STEM master's	**41%**	66%	54%	58%	44%	52%
Int. share of STEM research doctorates	**42%**	54%	45%	45%	44%	43%
Int. share of grad students	**8.9%**	22%	18%	18%	19%	17%
Int. share of undergraduate enrollment	**1.8%**	3.8%	3.9%	3.3%	2.6%	3.0%
Six-year graduation rate	**58%**	67%	68%	62%	57%	65%
In-state tuition, public 4-year	**$10K**	$15K	$17K	$11K	$7.14K	$9.71K
Appropriations per student	**$9.12K**	$10.3K	$7.14K	$7.76K	$10.8K	$11.4K
Average faculty salary	**$102K**	$112K	$109K	$93.3K	$95.3K	$106K
First-time students from in state	**61%**	80%	68%	76%	82%	–
Net migration per 100 residents	**+37**	−19	+8	+5	−6	–

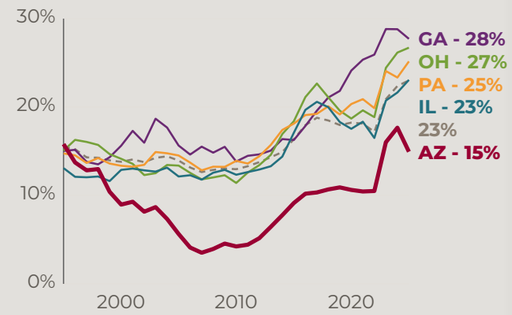
Latest year for each measure. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 23 Int. share of grad students



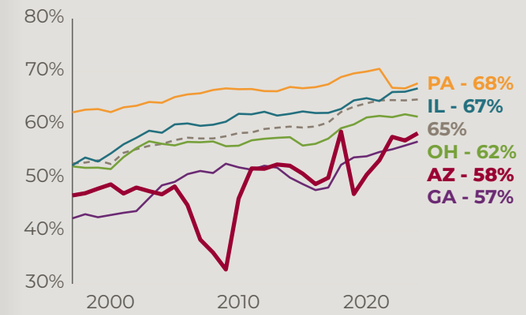
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 24 STEM share of master's



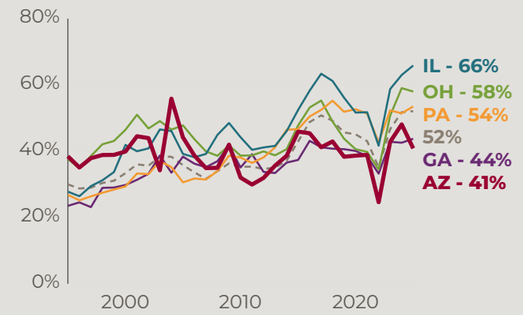
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 25 Six-year graduation rate



Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 26 Int. share of STEM master's

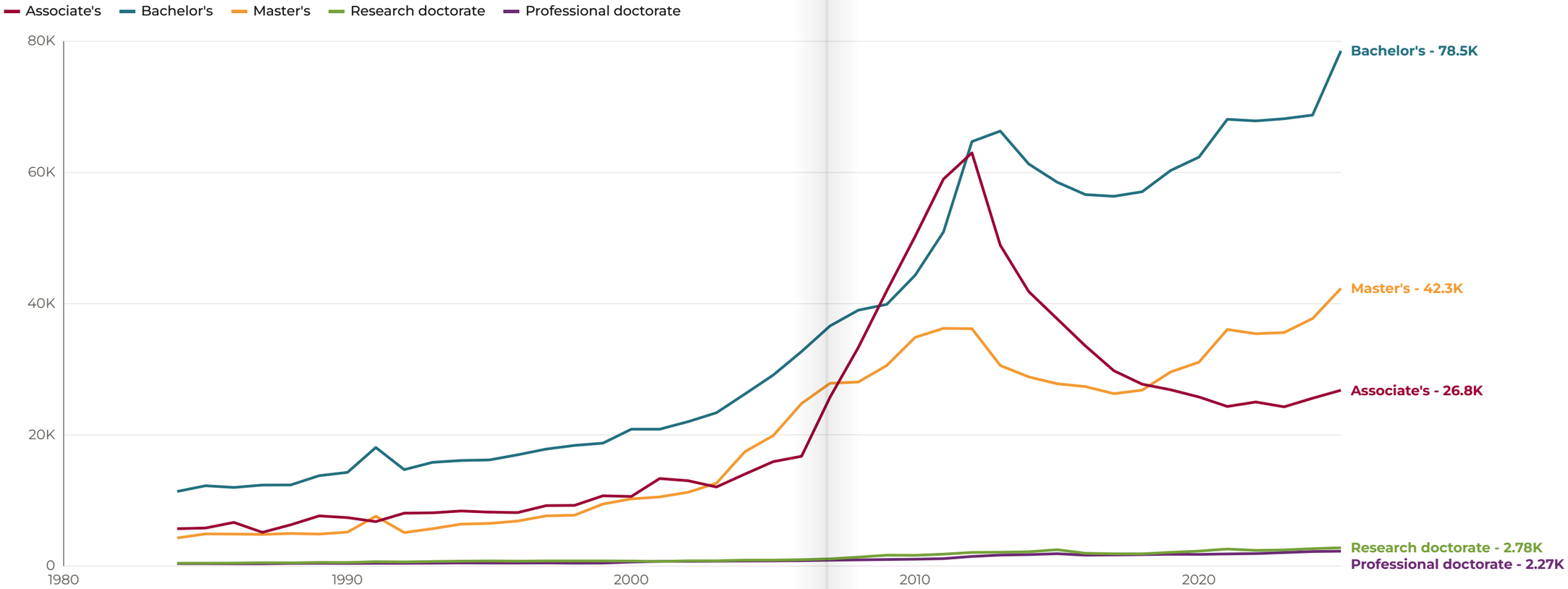


Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 12

Fields of Study

Figure 27 How Many Degrees Does Arizona Award?

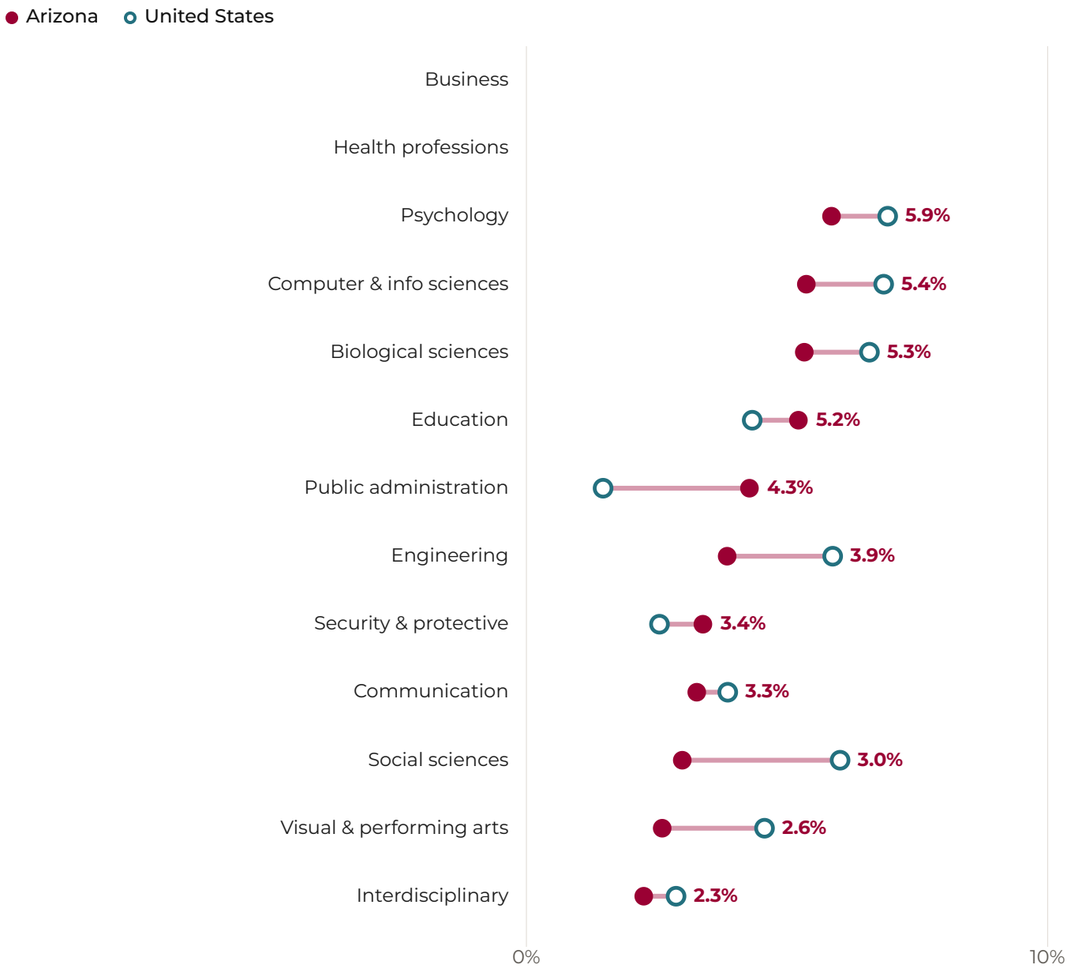


Degrees awarded by level, first majors. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

In 2025, Arizona's institutions awarded 26.8K associate's degrees, 78.5K bachelor's degrees, 42.3K master's degrees, 2.78K research doctorate degrees, 2.27K professional doctorate degrees.

Since 2015: associate's down 29%; bachelor's up 34%; master's up 52%; research doctorate up 12%; professional doctorate up 20%. The state awards 13.9 bachelor's degrees for every 100 undergraduates (U.S. 12.3).

Figure 28 What Do Arizona's Bachelor's Graduates Study?

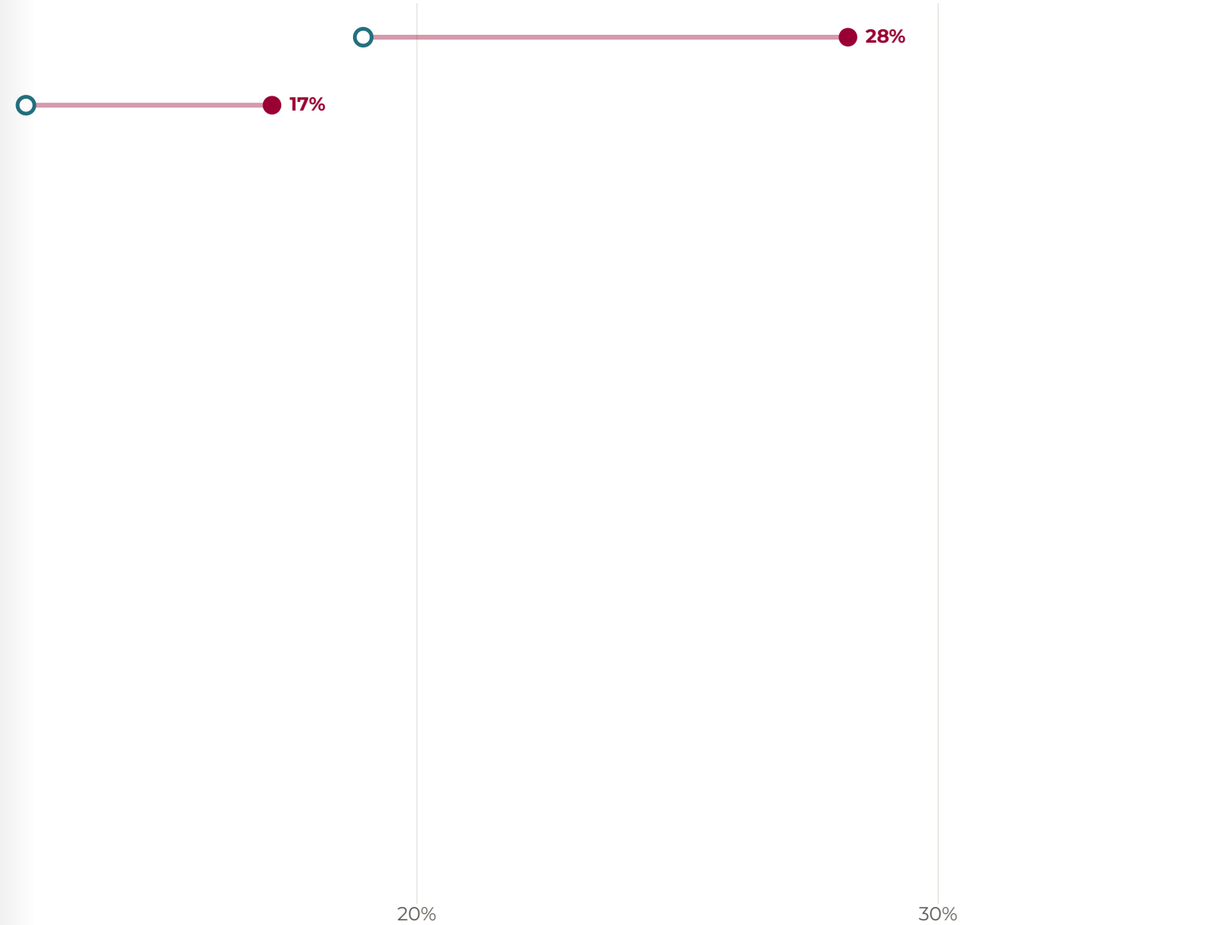


Share of bachelor's degrees by field, 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Arizona's largest bachelor's fields are business (28%; U.S. 19%), health professions (17%; U.S. 13%), psychology (5.9%; U.S. 6.9%).

Relative to the nation, Arizona's bachelor's degrees are most concentrated in science technologies (11.56× the U.S. share), military technologies (3.94× the U.S. share), public administration (2.91× the U.S. share).

ARIZONA · STATE TALENT PROFILE



5.4%

Bachelor's in computer science, 2025

U.S. **6.9%** · **30th** of 51 · +1.0 pp since 2015

4.2%

Bachelor's in engineering, 2025

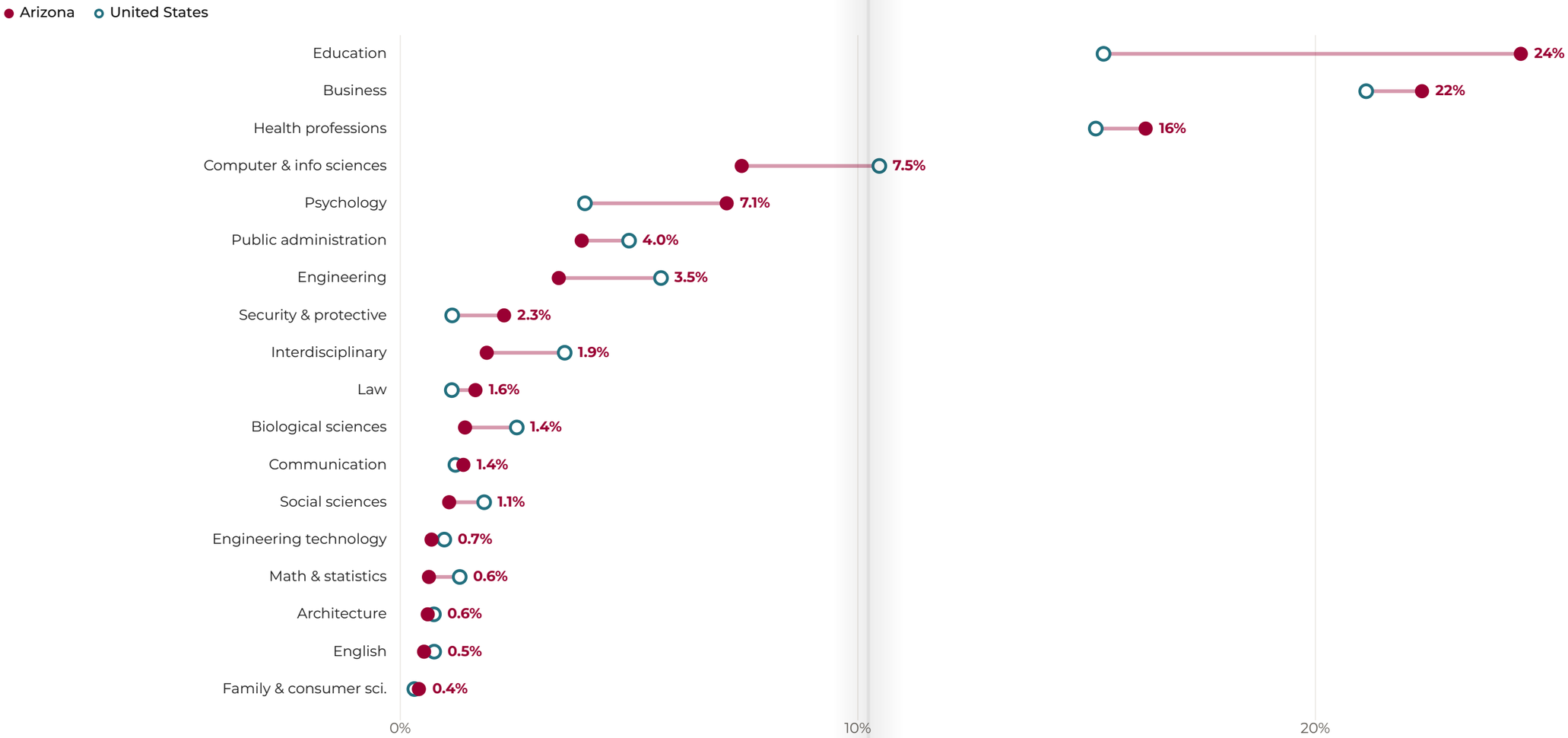
U.S. **6.8%** · **44th** of 51 · +1.0 pp since 2015

28%

Bachelor's in business, 2025

U.S. **19%** · **3rd** of 51 · +5.3 pp since 2015

Figure 29 What Do Arizona's Master's Graduates Study?



Share of master's degrees by field, 2025; largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Arizona's largest master's fields are education (24%; U.S. 15%), business (22%; U.S. 21%), health professions (16%; U.S. 15%).

International students earn 9.4% of all master's degrees in the state (U.S. 22%), and STEM fields account for 15% of them.

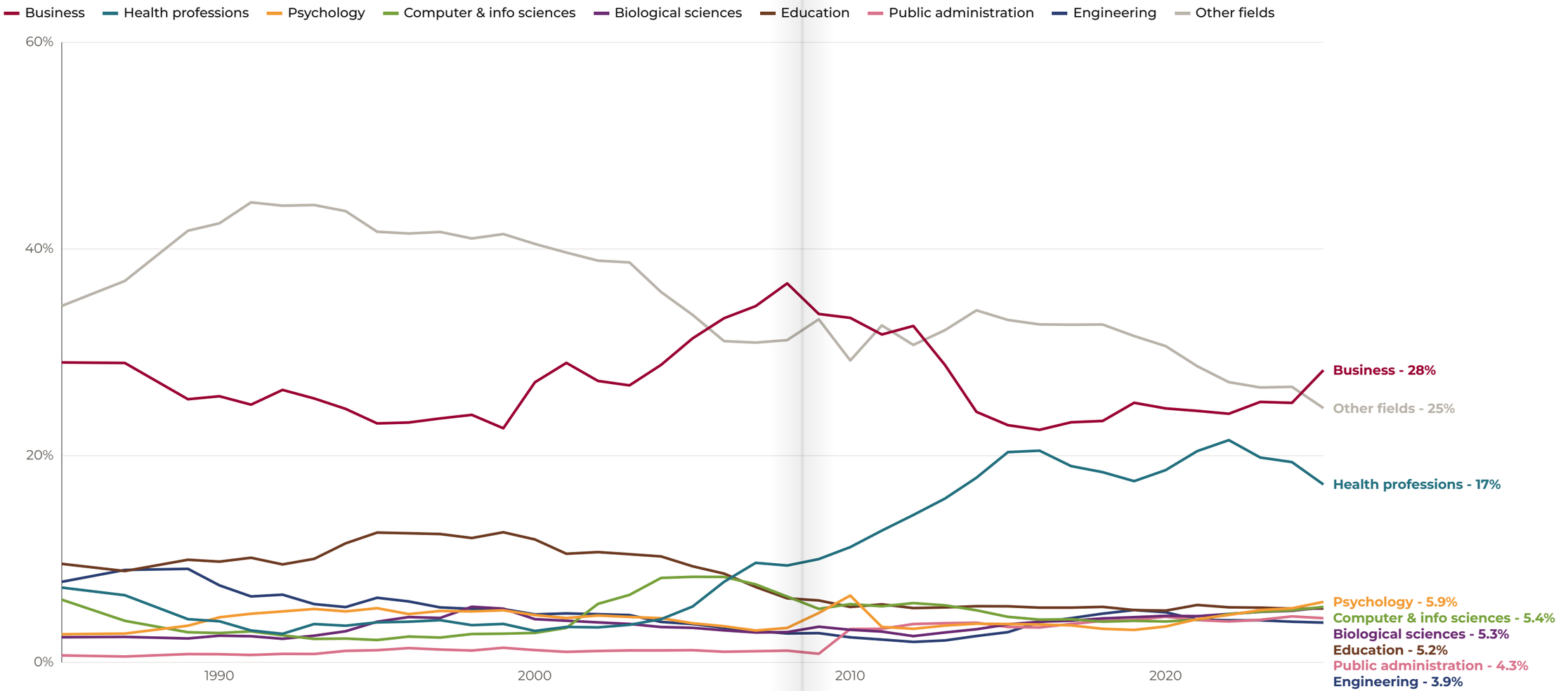
15%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **42nd** of 51 · +5.8 pp since 2015

9.4%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **39th** of 51 · +0.9 pp since 2015

46%
Int. share of CS master's, 2025
U.S. **65%** · **34th** of 47 · +1.0 pp since 2015

ARIZONA · STATE TALENT PROFILE

Figure 30 How Has Arizona's Bachelor's Field Mix Changed?



Share of bachelor's degrees in the largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Since 2015, business has gained the most ground, 5.3 points of the state's bachelor's degrees, while health professions lost the most (3.1 points).

The chart follows the share of bachelor's degrees in each of the state's largest fields; smaller fields are grouped as other fields.

Table 4 Where Is Arizona Most Specialized?

Field	Location quotient	State share	U.S. share	Degrees
Science technologies	**11.56**	0.3%	0.0%	208
Military technologies	**3.94**	0.3%	0.1%	272
Public administration	**2.91**	4.3%	1.5%	3.36K
Law	**1.95**	0.5%	0.2%	359
Business	**1.49**	28%	19%	22.2K
Theology	**1.41**	0.4%	0.3%	317
Health professions	**1.38**	17%	13%	13.5K
Security & protective	**1.33**	3.4%	2.6%	2.66K
Education	**1.21**	5.2%	4.3%	4.1K
Architecture	**1.18**	0.7%	0.6%	524

Bachelor's degrees; location quotient = state share ÷ U.S. share; fields with 50+ degrees. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

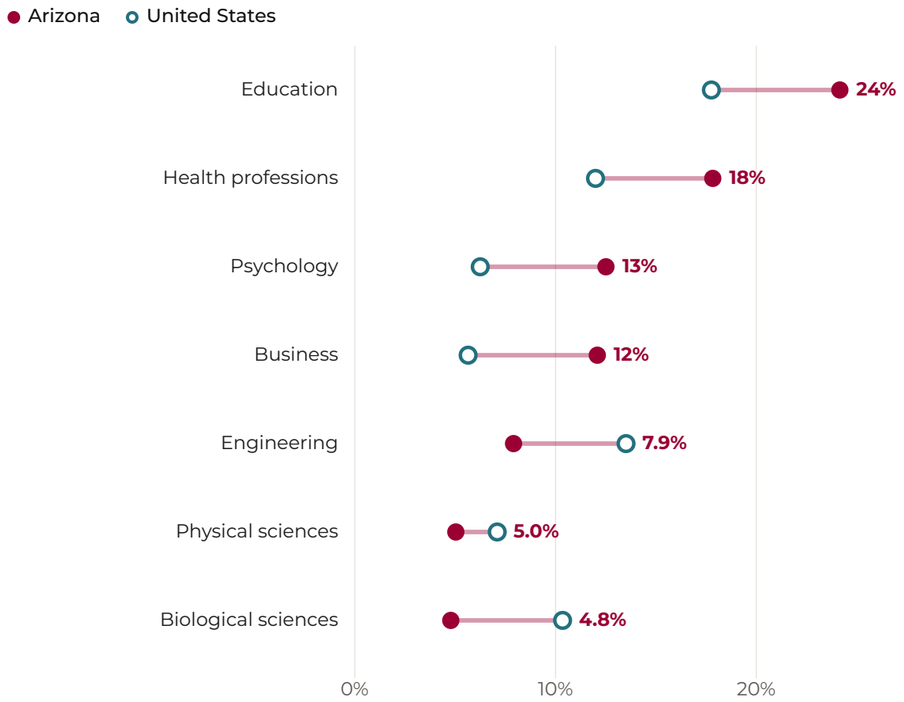
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The location quotient divides a field's share of Arizona's bachelor's degrees by its share of all U.S. bachelor's degrees in 2025. A quotient of 1.00 means the same share as the nation; 2.00 means twice the national share. The table lists the ten fields with the highest quotients among fields with at least 50 degrees.

THE NUMBERS

- **Highest location quotients**: science technologies 11.56 (0.3% of the state's bachelor's degrees; U.S. 0.0%); military technologies 3.94 (0.3% of the state's bachelor's degrees; U.S. 0.1%); public administration 2.91 (4.3% of the state's bachelor's degrees; U.S. 1.5%).
- **STEM share of bachelor's degrees**: 17% in 2025 (U.S. 24%; 47th of 51 states), up 0.3 points from 17% in 2024, and up 3.4 points since 2015 (14%).
- **Computer and information sciences**: 5.4% in 2025 (U.S. 6.9%; 30th of 51 states), up 0.3 points from 5.0% in 2024, and up 1.0 point since 2015 (4.4%).
- **Engineering**: 4.2% in 2025 (U.S. 6.8%; 44th of 51 states), down 0.1 points from 4.3% in 2024, and up 1.0 point since 2015 (3.3%).

Figure 31 What Do Arizona's Doctoral Graduates Study?



Share of research doctorates by field, 2025; fields with 20+ doctorates. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each row is a field's share of the research doctorates awarded in Arizona in 2025 (filled dot), against its share nationally (open dot), for the ten largest fields with at least 20 doctorates. Research doctorates exclude professional doctorates such as the M.D. and J.D.

THE NUMBERS

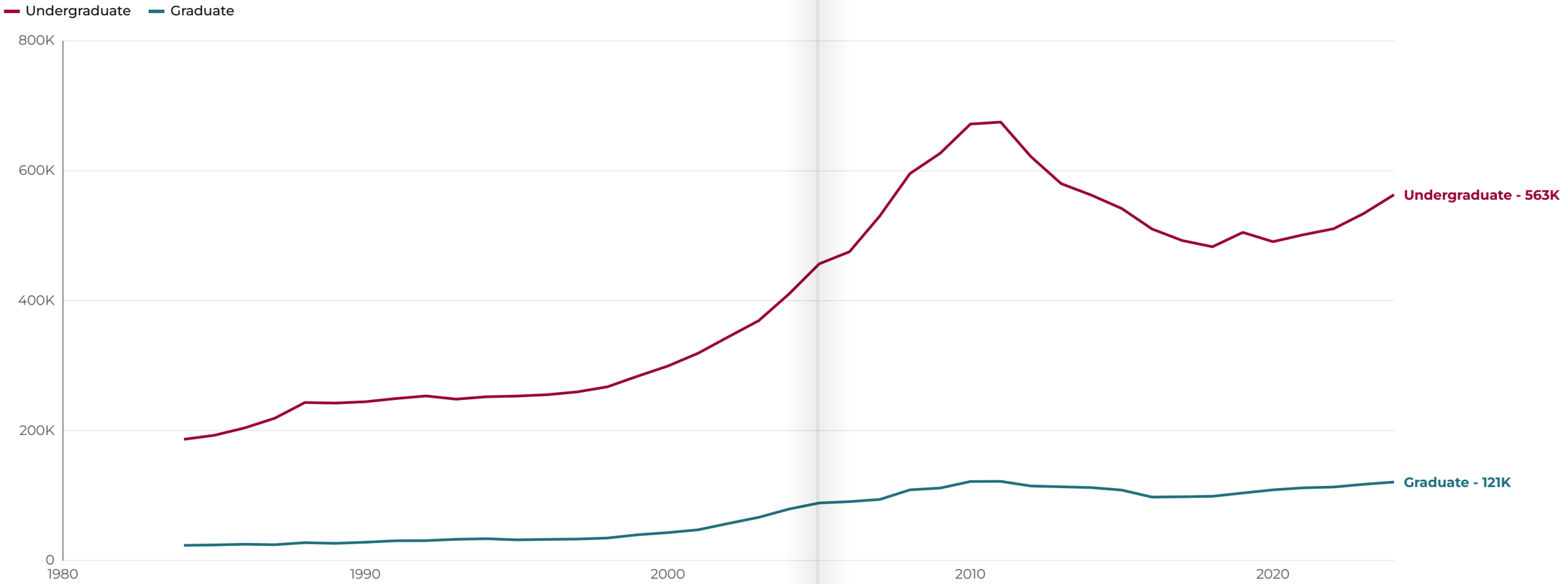
- **Largest doctoral fields**: education 24% (U.S. 18%); health professions 18% (U.S. 12%); psychology 13% (U.S. 6.2%).
- **STEM share of research doctorates**: 22% in 2025 (U.S. 39%; 48th of 51 states), up 0.3 points from 22% in 2024, and up 2.4 points since 2015 (20%).
- **International share of research doctorates**: 14% in 2025 (U.S. 25%; 46th of 51 states), unchanged from 14% in 2024, and down 1.3 points since 2015 (16%).
- **International share of STEM research doctorates**: 42% in 2025 (U.S. 43%; 25th of 51 states), up 0.8 points from 42% in 2024, and down 2.9 points since 2015 (45%).

ARIZONA · STATE TALENT PROFILE

SECTION 13

Students and Money

Figure 32 How Has Enrollment Changed?



Fall headcount enrollment. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

In fall 2024, Arizona enrolled 563K undergraduates and 121K graduate students, 684K in all (6th of 51).

Undergraduate enrollment is up 4% since 2015 and graduate enrollment up 11% since 2015. Graduate students are 18% of all students (U.S. 17%).

684K

Students enrolled, 2024

U.S. **19.7M** · **6th** of 51 · +5.2% since 2015

18%

Graduate share of students, 2024

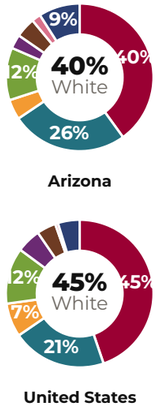
U.S. **17%** · **15th** of 51 · +1.0 pp since 2015

43%

Students attending part-time, 2024

U.S. **39%** · **14th** of 51 · +6.4 pp since 2015

Figure 33 Who Enrolls in Arizona?



	Arizona	United States
White	**40%**	45%
Hispanic	**26%**	21%
Asian / Pacific Islander	**4.4%**	7.4%
Black	**12%**	12%
International	**3.1%**	5.3%
Two or more	**4.4%**	4.2%
American Indian	**2.0%**	0.6%
Unknown	**9.0%**	4.8%

Share of fall 2024 enrollment by race and ethnicity. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

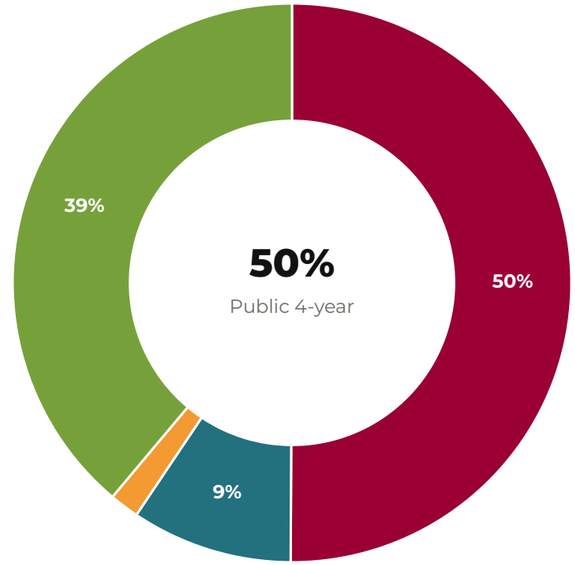
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The rings divide fall 2024 headcount enrollment at Arizona's degree-granting institutions by race and ethnicity, with the nation for comparison. "International" counts U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, whatever their race; "Unknown" is students whose race was not reported.

THE NUMBERS

- **White**: 40% in fall 2024 (U.S. 45%), down 0.9 points from 41% in fall 2023, and down 2.6 points since fall 2015 (43%).
- **Hispanic**: 26% in fall 2024 (U.S. 21%), up 0.5 points from 25% in fall 2023, and up 6.1 points since fall 2015 (19%).
- **Black**: 12% in fall 2024 (U.S. 12%), up 0.6 points from 11% in fall 2023, and up 0.8 points since fall 2015 (11%).
- **Unknown**: 9.0% in fall 2024 (U.S. 4.8%), down 0.1 points from 9.1% in fall 2023, and down 5.4 points since fall 2015 (14%).
- **Asian / Pacific Islander**: 4.4% in fall 2024 (U.S. 7.4%), unchanged from 4.4% in fall 2023, and up 0.9 points since fall 2015 (3.5%).

Figure 34 Where Do Students Enroll?



	Share
Public 4-year	**50%**
Public 2-year	**9.3%**
Private nonprofit	**1.7%**
For-profit	**39%**

Share of fall 2024 enrollment by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

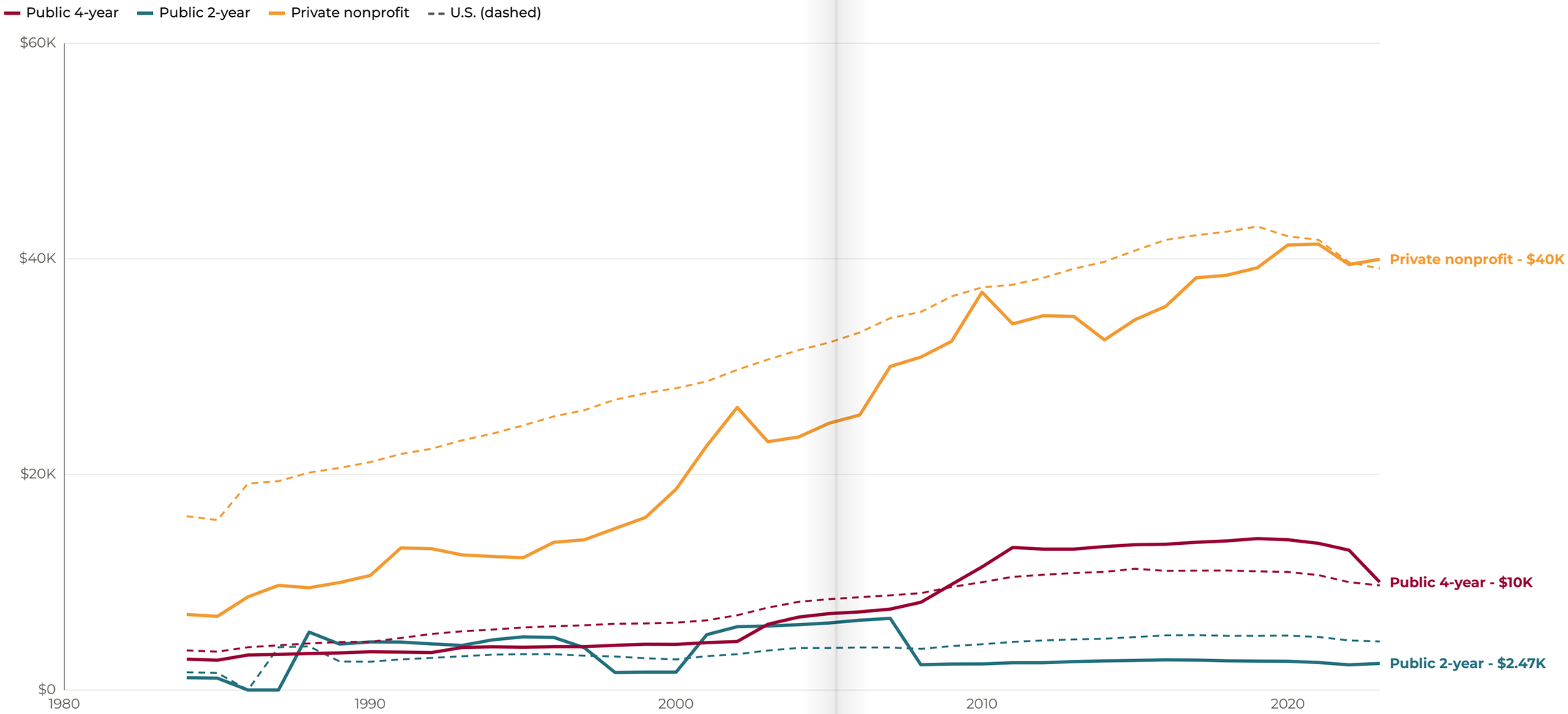
The ring divides fall 2024 headcount enrollment in Arizona among public four-year, public two-year, private nonprofit and for-profit institutions.

THE NUMBERS

- **Public 4-year share of enrollment**: 50% in fall 2024, up 7.3 points from 43% in fall 2023, and up 24.7 points since fall 2015 (25%).
- **Public 2-year share of enrollment**: 9.3% in fall 2024, down 7.7 points from 17% in fall 2023, and down 20.8 points since fall 2015 (30%).
- **Private nonprofit share of enrollment**: 1.7% in fall 2024, unchanged from 1.7% in fall 2023, and up 0.2 points since fall 2015 (1.5%).
- **For-profit share of enrollment**: 39% in fall 2024, up 0.4 points from 38% in fall 2023, and down 4.1 points since fall 2015 (43%).

ARIZONA · STATE TALENT PROFILE

Figure 35 What Does In-State Tuition Cost?



Published in-state tuition and fees, 2024 dollars (CPI-U); state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

In-state tuition and fees at Arizona's public four-year institutions are $10K (2023, 2024 dollars), 3% above the U.S. ($9.71K); the state ranks 26th of 51.

State and local appropriations come to $9.12K per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions (37th of 51), and tuition makes up 59% of their core revenue (U.S. 43%).

$10K

In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023

U.S. **$9.71K** · **26th** of 51 · −26% since 2015

$9.12K

Appropriations per student, 2024

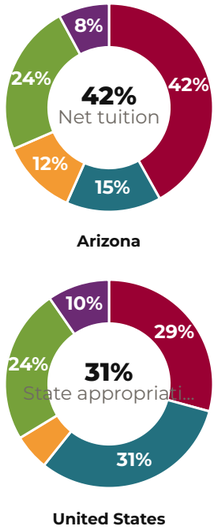
U.S. **$11.4K** · **37th** of 51 · −3.6% since 2015

59%

Tuition share of public revenue, 2024

U.S. **43%** · **10th** of 51 · +3.4 pp since 2015

Figure 36 How Are Public Institutions Funded?



	Arizona	United States
Net tuition	**42%**	29%
State appropriations	**15%**	31%
Local appropriations	**12%**	5.6%
Federal grants & appropriations	**24%**	24%
Private gifts & grants	**7.9%**	9.6%

Core revenue per FTE student, public institutions. Data from NCES, IPEDS Finance.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The rings divide the core revenue of Arizona's public institutions per full-time-equivalent (FTE) student by source, with the nation for comparison. Values are in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Net tuition is tuition and fees after institutional discounts and allowances.

THE NUMBERS

- **Net tuition per FTE student**: $14.4K in FY2024 (U.S. $8.96K), up 0.3% from $14.3K in FY2023, and up 14% since FY2015 ($12.6K).
- **State appropriations per FTE student**: $5.05K in FY2024 (U.S. $9.64K), down 3.5% from $5.24K in FY2023, and up 1.5% since FY2015 ($4.98K).
- **Local appropriations per FTE student**: $4.06K in FY2024 (U.S. $1.71K), down 4.1% from $4.24K in FY2023, and down 9.2% since FY2015 ($4.47K).
- **Federal grants & appropriations per FTE student**: $8.09K in FY2024 (U.S. $7.36K), up 2.9% from $7.86K in FY2023, and up 17% since FY2015 ($6.89K).

Table 5 Money and Results

Measure	Year	Arizona	U.S.	Rank	Change since 2015
In-state tuition, public 4-year	2023	**$10K**	$9.71K	26th of 51	−26%
Appropriations per student	2024	**$9.12K**	$11.4K	37th of 51	−3.6%
Tuition share of public revenue	2024	**59%**	43%	10th of 51	+3.4 pp
Six-year graduation rate	2024	**58%**	65%	37th of 51	+7.6 pp
Average faculty salary	2024	**$102K**	$106K	18th of 51	−6.5%

Rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Dollars in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The table brings together five measures of what public higher education costs and what it produces in Arizona: in-state tuition at public four-year institutions, state and local appropriations per full-time-equivalent student, tuition's share of public institutions' core revenue, the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, and the average full-time faculty salary.

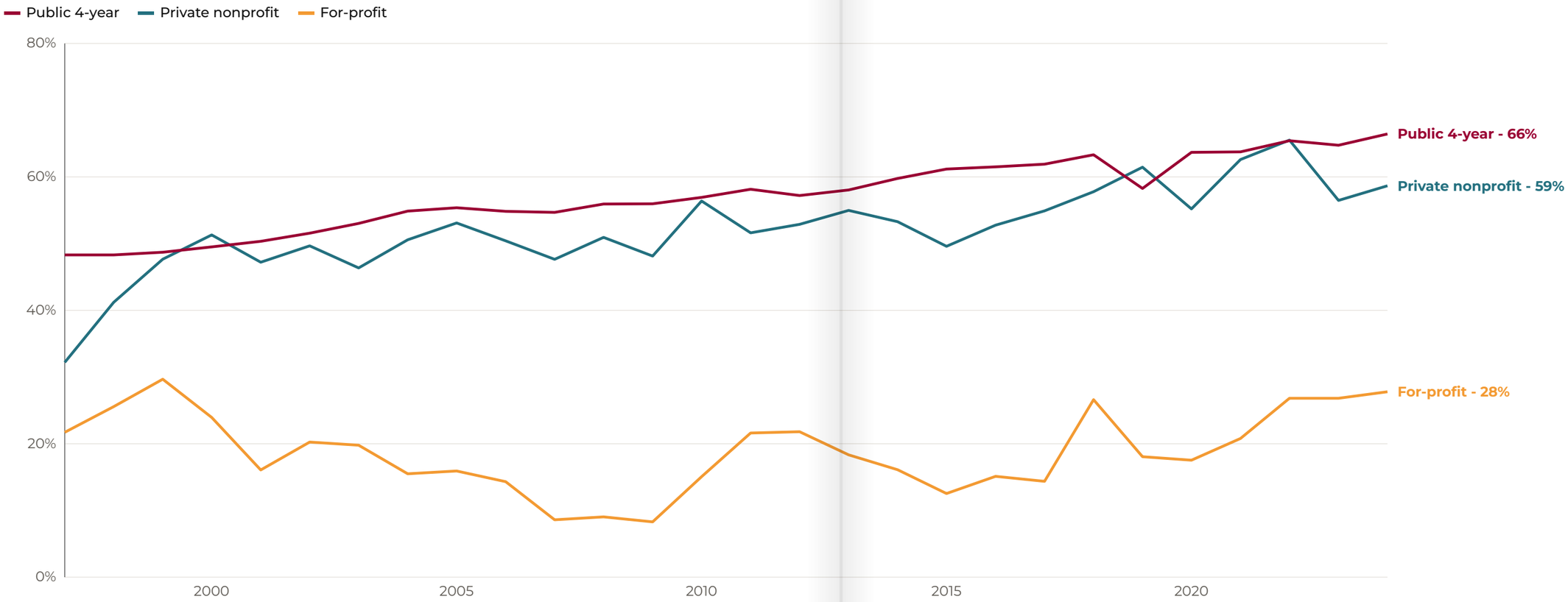
THE NUMBERS

- **In-state tuition, public 4-year**: $10K in 2023 (U.S. $9.71K; 26th of 51 states), down 23% from $13K in 2022, and down 26% since 2015 ($13.5K).
- **Appropriations per student**: $9.12K in 2024 (U.S. $11.4K; 37th of 51 states), down 3.8% from $9.48K in 2023, and down 3.6% since 2015 ($9.46K).
- **Tuition share of public revenue**: 59% in 2024 (U.S. 43%; 10th of 51 states), up 1.1 points from 58% in 2023, and up 3.4 points since 2015 (55%).
- **Six-year graduation rate**: 58% in 2024 (U.S. 65%; 37th of 51 states), up 1.4 points from 57% in 2023, and up 7.6 points since 2015 (51%).

SECTION 14

Student Outcomes

Figure 37 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Sector?



Six-year bachelor's graduation rate by sector of institution. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

58% of students who started a bachelor's degree at a four-year institution in Arizona graduated within six years (2024), 6.4 points below the U.S. (65%); the state ranks 37th of 51.

By sector: public 4-year 66%, private nonprofit 59%, for-profit 28%. At two-year institutions, 47% complete within 150% of normal time (U.S. 41%).

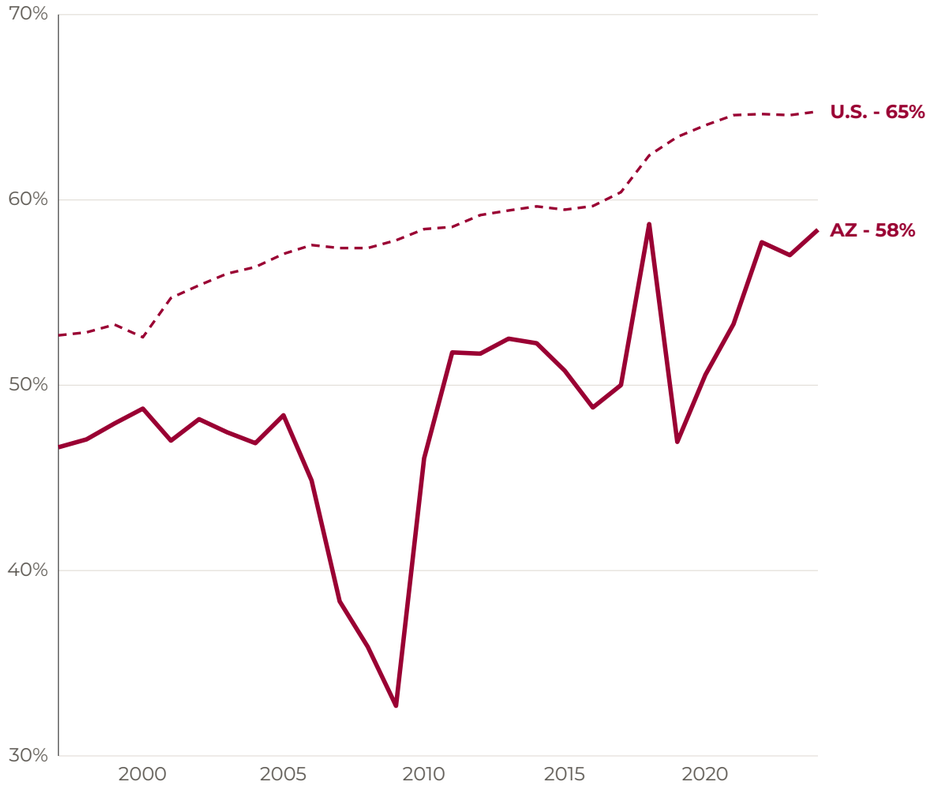
58%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **37th** of 51 · +7.6 pp since 2015

47%
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · **11th** of 50 · +15.9 pp since 2015

13.9
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · **13th** of 51 · +3.5 since 2015

ARIZONA · STATE TALENT PROFILE

Figure 38 Six-Year Bachelor's Graduation Rate



Four-year institutions; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

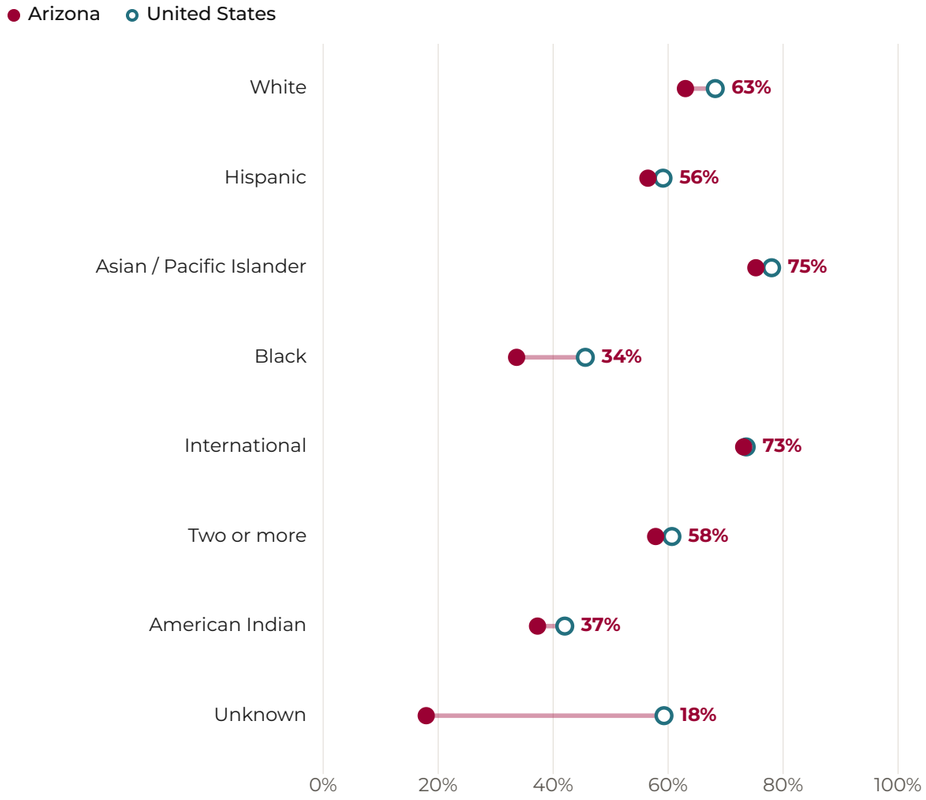
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The line follows the share of first-time, full-time bachelor's-degree students at Arizona's four-year institutions who graduated from the institution where they started within six years (150% of normal time). Each year is the cohort that entered six years earlier. The state is solid and the United States dashed.

THE NUMBERS

- **Six-year graduation rate**: 58% in 2024 (U.S. 65%), up 1.4 points from 57% in 2023, and up 7.6 points since 2015 (51%).
- **Public 4-year institutions**: 66% in 2024, up 1.7 points from 65% in 2023, and up 5.3 points since 2015 (61%).
- **Private nonprofit institutions**: 59% in 2024, up 2.2 points from 56% in 2023, and up 9.1 points since 2015 (50%).
- **For-profit institutions**: 28% in 2024, up 1.0 point from 27% in 2023, and up 15.3 points since 2015 (13%).
- **Two-year institutions, completion within 150% of normal time**: 47% in 2024 (U.S. 41%), up 5.9 points from 41% in 2023, and up 15.9 points since 2015 (31%).
- **State rank on the six-year rate**: 58% in 2024 (U.S. 65%; 37th of 51 states), up 1.4 points from 57% in 2023, and up 7.6 points since 2015 (51%).

Figure 39 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Race and Ethnicity?



Six-year rate, 2024; groups with 100+ students. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Each row is the six-year bachelor's graduation rate for one racial or ethnic group of students at Arizona's four-year institutions (filled dot), against the national rate for the same group (open dot). Groups with fewer than 100 students in the cohort are left out.

THE NUMBERS

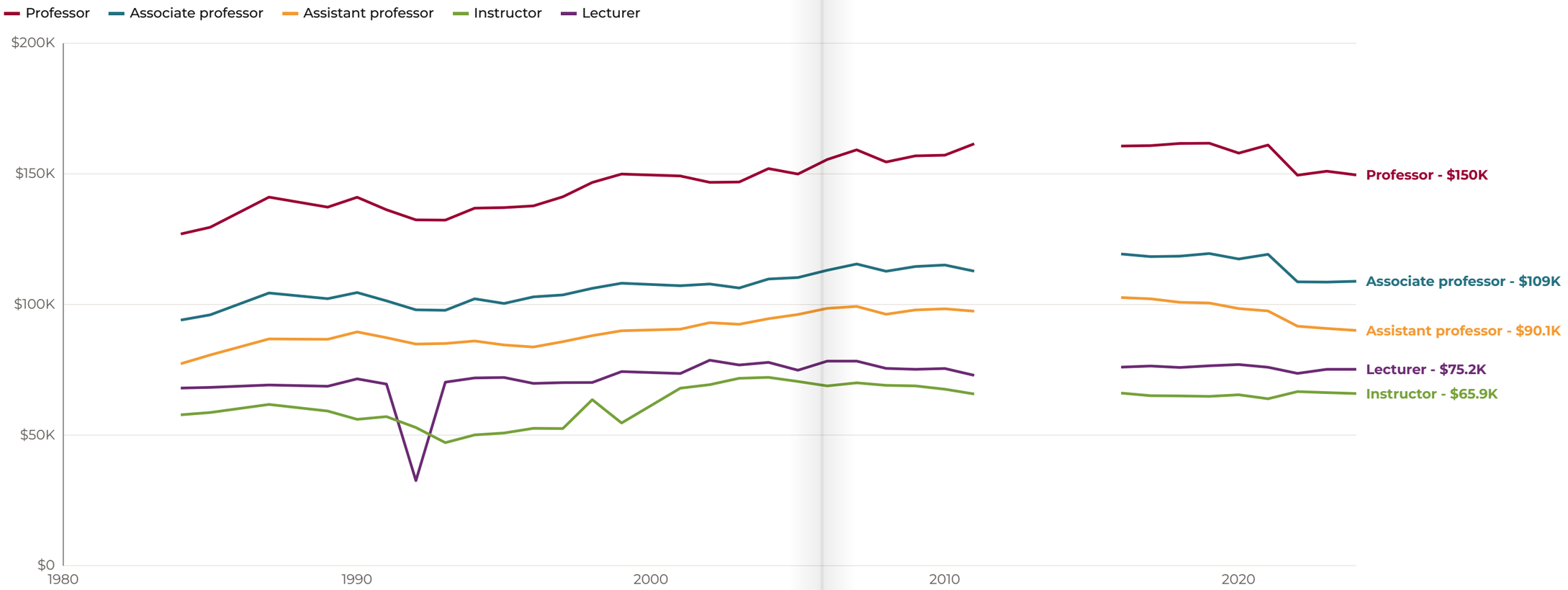
- **White**: 63% in 2024 (U.S. 68%).
- **Hispanic**: 56% in 2024 (U.S. 59%).
- **Asian / Pacific Islander**: 75% in 2024 (U.S. 78%).
- **Black**: 34% in 2024 (U.S. 46%).
- **International**: 73% in 2024 (U.S. 74%).
- **Two or more**: 58% in 2024 (U.S. 61%).
- **American Indian**: 37% in 2024 (U.S. 42%).

ARIZONA · STATE TALENT PROFILE

SECTION 15

Faculty

Figure 40 What Do Arizona's Faculty Earn, by Rank?



Average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts, by academic rank, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS Human Resources.

Full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts at Arizona's institutions earned an average of $102K in 2024 (2024 dollars), 4% below the U.S. ($106K); the state ranks 18th of 51. By rank (2024): professors $150K, associate professors $109K, assistant professors $90.1K, instructors $65.9K, lecturers $75.2K.

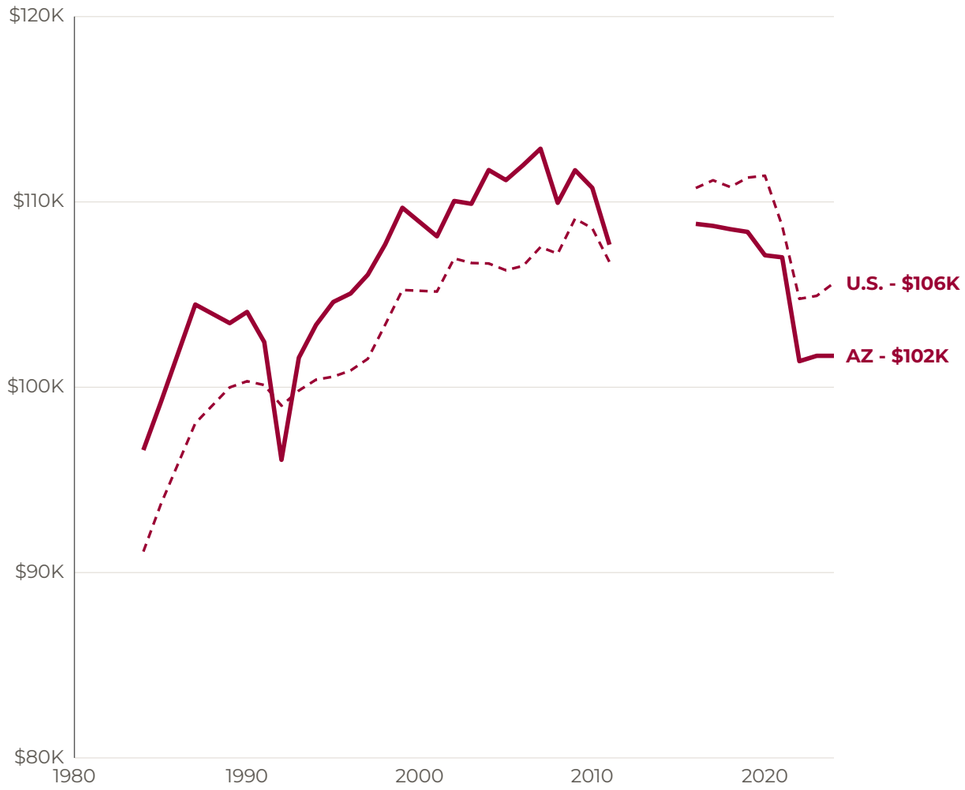
Arizona's institutions had 12.5K full-time instructional staff in 2024, up 20% since 2015. Average salary across all ranks is down 7% since 2016.

$102K

Average faculty salary, 2024

U.S. **$106K** · **18th** of 51 · −6.5% since 2016

Figure 41 Average Faculty Salary



Full-time instructional faculty, 9/10-month, 2024 dollars. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

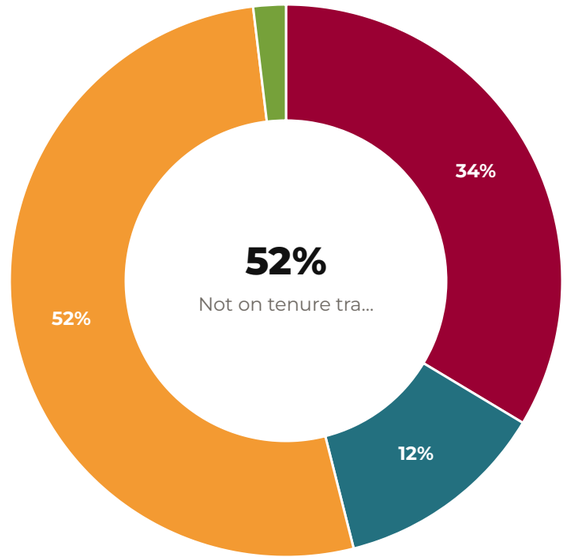
ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The line follows the average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9- or 10-month contracts at Arizona's degree-granting institutions, all ranks combined, in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). The state is solid and the United States dashed.

THE NUMBERS

- **Average salary**: $102K in 2024 (U.S. $106K), unchanged from $102K in 2023, and down 6.5% since 2016 ($109K).
- **State rank on average salary**: $102K in 2024 (U.S. $106K; 18th of 51 states), unchanged from $102K in 2023, and down 6.5% since 2016 ($109K).
- **Full-time instructional staff**: 12.5K in 2024, up 2.7% from 12.2K in 2023, and up 20% since 2015 (10.5K).
- **Professors, average salary**: $150K in 2024, down 0.9% from $151K in 2023, and down 6.9% since 2016 ($161K).
- **Associate professors, average salary**: $109K in 2024, up 0.3% from $109K in 2023, and down 8.8% since 2016 ($119K).
- **Assistant professors, average salary**: $90.1K in 2024, down 0.8% from $90.8K in 2023, and down 12% since 2016 ($103K).

Figure 42 Tenure Status



	Share
Tenured	34%
On tenure track	12%
Not on tenure track	52%
No faculty status	1.9%

Full-time instructional staff, 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

The ring divides Arizona's full-time instructional staff in 2024 by tenure status: tenured, on the tenure track, not on the tenure track (for example, lecturers on fixed-term contracts), and staff at institutions with no tenure system.

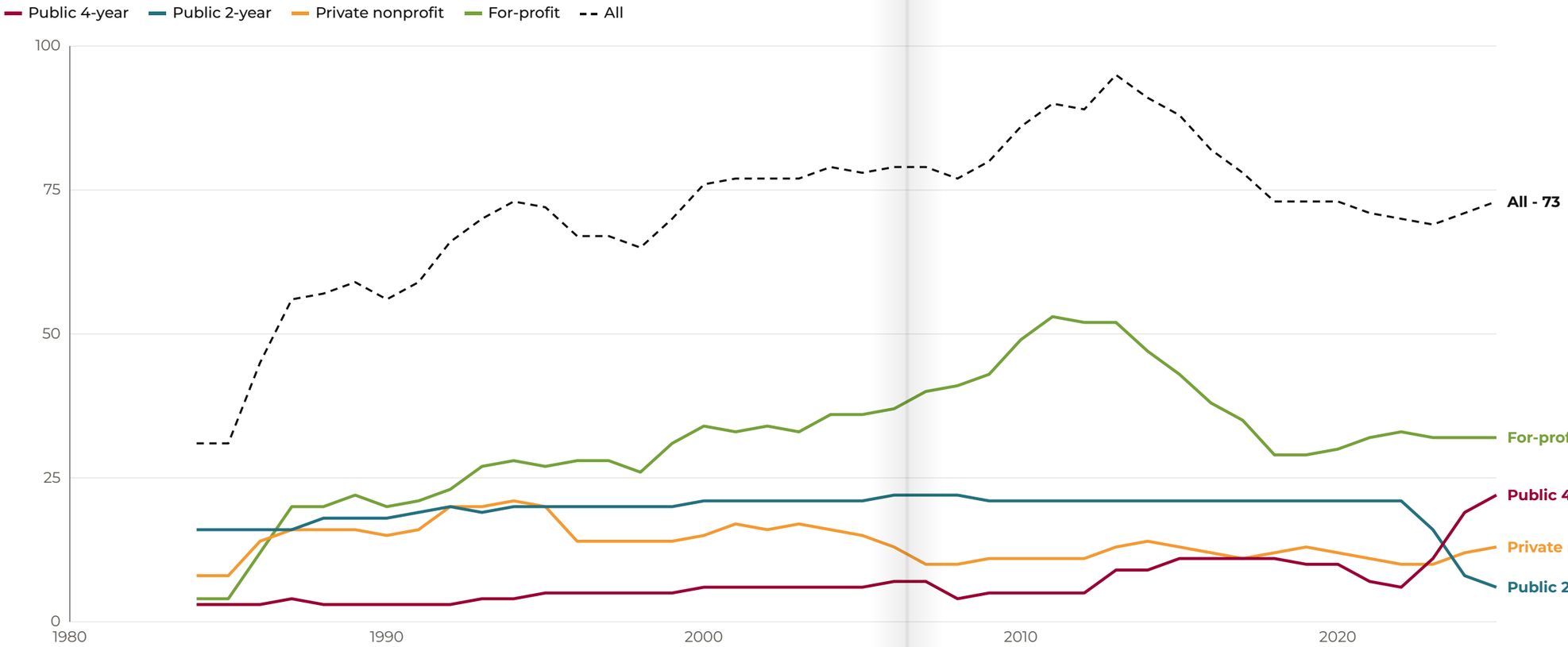
THE NUMBERS

- **Tenured, share of full-time instructional staff**: 34% in 2024, down 0.1 points from 34% in 2023, and down 4.8 points since 2015 (38%).
- **On tenure track, share of full-time instructional staff**: 12% in 2024, down 0.3 points from 13% in 2023, and down 1.1 points since 2015 (14%).
- **Not on tenure track, share of full-time instructional staff**: 52% in 2024, up 0.3 points from 52% in 2023, and up 5.2 points since 2015 (47%).
- **No faculty status, share of full-time instructional staff**: 1.9% in 2024, up 0.1 points from 1.8% in 2023, and up 0.6 points since 2015 (1.3%).

SECTION 16

Institutions

Figure 43 How Many Institutions Does Arizona Have?



Degree-granting institutions by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Arizona has 69 degree-granting institutions: 22 public 4-year, 6 public 2-year, 13 private nonprofit, 32 for-profit (2025).

The number of institutions is down 17% since 2015. 59% of students attend public institutions and 39% attend for-profit ones.

59%

Students at public institutions, 2024

U.S. **73%** · **41st** of 51 · +3.9 pp since 2015

39%

Students at for-profit institutions, 2024

U.S. **5.5%** · **2nd** of 51 · −4.1 pp since 2015

54%

Students fully online, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **2nd** of 51 · +8.2 pp since 2015

Table 6 Which Institutions Train the Most International STEM Graduates?

Institution	Intl STEM master's	Int. share	Intl STEM doctorates	Int. share
Arizona State University Campus Immersion Tempe · Public 4-year	**1.97K**	73%	175	48%
University of Arizona Tucson · Public 4-year	**261**	36%	86	38%
Northern Arizona University Flagstaff · Public 4-year	**248**	26%	4	13%
Arizona State University Digital Immersion Scottsdale · Public 4-year	**84**	7.8%	–	–
Grand Canyon University Phoenix · Private nonprofit	**17**	3.4%	–	–
Midwestern University-Glendale Glendale · Private nonprofit	**5**	3.8%	–	–

Degrees awarded in 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Institutions in Arizona ranked by the STEM master's and research doctorates they awarded to international students in 2025. The share columns give international students' share of each institution's STEM degrees at that level.

THE NUMBERS

- **Largest**: Arizona State University Campus Immersion (1.97K international STEM master's, 175 doctorates); University of Arizona (261 international STEM master's, 86 doctorates); Northern Arizona University (248 international STEM master's, 4 doctorates).
- **International STEM master's degrees, all institutions**: 2.58K in 2025 (U.S. 117K; 15th of 51 states), down 19% from 3.21K in 2024, and up 121% since 2015 (1.17K).
- **International share of STEM research doctorates**: 42% in 2025 (U.S. 43%; 25th of 51 states), up 0.8 points from 42% in 2024, and down 2.9 points since 2015 (45%).

Table 7 What Are Arizona's Largest Institutions?

Institution	Enrollment	Int. share, grad	STEM bachelor's	Six-year grad rate	Admit rate
Grand Canyon University	**113K**	0.8%	949	43%	79%
University of Phoenix-Arizona	**111K**	0.7%	1.32K	16%	–
Arizona State University Campus Immersion	**79.8K**	51%	5.21K	68%	90%
Arizona State University Digital Immersion	**73K**	1.7%	1.95K	–	67%
University of Arizona	**56.4K**	17%	2.26K	68%	86%
Northern Arizona University	**28.5K**	12%	1K	61%	90%
Rio Salado College	**18.8K**	–	–	–	–
Mesa Community College	**17.1K**	–	–	–	–
Pima Community College	**16.3K**	–	–	–	–
Chandler-Gilbert Community College	**15.1K**	–	–	–	–
Glendale Community College	**13.9K**	–	–	–	–
American InterContinental University System	**11.3K**	–	192	5.7%	–
Phoenix College	**10.7K**	–	–	–	–
Estrella Mountain Community College	**10.1K**	–	–	–	–

Fall 2024 enrollment; degrees 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

ABOUT THIS FIGURE

Arizona's largest degree-granting institutions by fall 2024 headcount enrollment, with the international share of graduate students, STEM bachelor's degrees awarded in 2025, the six-year graduation rate and the admission rate (a dash where the institution admits all applicants or does not report one).

THE NUMBERS

- **Largest**: Grand Canyon University (113K students); University of Phoenix-Arizona (111K students); Arizona State University Campus Immersion (79.8K students).
- **Degree-granting institutions**: 69.
- **Share of students at public institutions**: 59% in 2024 (U.S. 73%; 41st of 51 states), down 0.5 points from 60% in 2023, and up 3.9 points since 2015 (55%).
- **Share at for-profit institutions**: 39% in 2024 (U.S. 5.5%; 2nd of 51 states), up 0.4 points from 38% in 2023, and down 4.1 points since 2015 (43%).

NOTES

About These Data

International students

U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, as IPEDS defines them. IPEDS does not record country of citizenship. Permanent residents count with U.S. citizens.

STEM

CIP families 03, 04, 11, 14, 15, 26, 27 and 40. Doctorates are research and scholarship doctorates; professional doctorates appear only in the degree-count figure. Degrees are first majors only.

Universe

Degree-granting institutions located in the state; Title IV participants from 1996. Geography is the institution's location, not the student's home. Enrollment is fall headcount.

Migration

First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by home state, reported in even years before 2001 and every year since; odd years with incomplete reporting are omitted. Net migration is students arriving from other states minus residents leaving, per 100 resident first-time students.

Money

All dollar values are in 2024 dollars using the CPI-U. Appropriations and revenue are per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions.

Race and ethnicity

IPEDS did not collect race and ethnicity in every year before 2010, and categories changed in 2008–2010; “Two or more” exists only from then.

Countries of citizenship

From DHS SEVIS by the Numbers: active F-1 and M-1 student records in the month named, at every level from primary school to doctorate, by the state of the school. IPEDS records only whether a student is a U.S. nonresident, not where they come from. SEVIS counts are monthly snapshots and are not directly comparable with IPEDS fall enrollment or degree counts.

Peers

Comparison states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

Source

National Center for Education Statistics, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS): Institutional Characteristics, Fall Enrollment, Completions, Graduation Rates, Finance, Human Resources and Admissions components, 1980–2025, harmonized into a state panel. Department of Homeland Security, SEVIS by the Numbers data mapping tool, 2014–2026. Generated November 2026.

ARIZONA · STATE TALENT PROFILE

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Arizona – By the Numbers

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION							
Grade 8 mathematics, average score	283	**270**[2024]	−13.3 ▼	272	−9.0 ▼	#33	[5]
Grade 8 mathematics: at or above Proficient	35%	**26%**[2024]	−9.0 pp ▼	27%	−5.3 pp ▼	#28	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics, average score	238	**232**[2024]	−5.2 ▼	237	−2.5 ▼	#45	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics: at or above Proficient	38%	**34%**[2024]	−4.0 pp ▼	39%	0.0 pp	#43	[5]
Grade 8 reading, average score	263	**254**[2024]	−8.4 ▼	257	−7.3 ▼	#39	[5]
Grade 8 reading: at or above Proficient	31%	**25%**[2024]	−5.7 pp ▼	29%	−4.0 pp ▼	#37	[5]
Grade 4 reading, average score	215	**208**[2024]	−7.2 ▼	214	−7.1 ▼	#46	[5]
Grade 8 science, average score, 2009 framework	–	**148**[2015]	–	153	–	#41	[5]
Current spending per public-school pupil	$9.93K	**$11.3K**[2021]	+13% ▲	$16.8K	+12% ▲	#49	[3]
Public high school 4-year graduation rate, ACGR	77%	**77%**[2022]	0.0 pp	87%	+4.0 pp ▲	#48	[3]
Public high school graduates	66.7K	**79.7K**[2024]	+20% ▲	3.49M	+8.8% ▲	#13	[3]
Average public-school teacher salary	$59.4K	**$59.9K**[2022]	+0.9% ▲	$72.9K	−3.0% ▼	#36	[3]
Pupils per teacher, public schools	23.1	**22.8**[2022]	−0.3 ▼	15.4	−0.6 ▼	#1	[3]
Public elementary and secondary enrollment	1.11M	**1.1M**[2024]	−0.5% ▼	49.4M	−2.1% ▼	#13	[3]
Public-school students eligible for free or reduced-price lunch	43%	**50%**[2023]	+7.3 pp ▲	53%	+1.5 pp ▲	#24	[3]
English learners as a share of public-school students	7.0%	**8.2%**[2022]	+1.2 pp ▲	11%	+1.0 pp ▲	#23	[3]
Charter-school share of public-school enrollment	19%	**21%**[2023]	+1.9 pp ▲	7.6%	+2.2 pp ▲	#2	[3]
High schools offering calculus	43%[2016]	**43%**[2024]	−0.2 pp ▼	51%	−5.8 pp ▼	#34	[14]
High schools offering physics	54%[2016]	**55%**[2024]	+1.2 pp ▲	64%	−2.4 pp ▼	#35	[14]
High schools offering chemistry	69%[2016]	**74%**[2024]	+5.3 pp ▲	81%	+0.7 pp ▲	#42	[14]
High schools offering Algebra II	90%[2016]	**89%**[2024]	−0.9 pp ▼	87%	+1.3 pp ▲	#25	[14]
High schools offering computer science	38%[2021]	**40%**[2024]	+2.0 pp ▲	55%	+2.0 pp ▲	#45	[14]
High schools offering any AP course	38%[2016]	**42%**[2024]	+3.5 pp ▲	56%	0.0 pp	#39	[14]
High schools offering AP computer science	17%[2021]	**19%**[2024]	+1.7 pp ▲	25%	+2.6 pp ▲	#33	[14]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

ARIZONA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION (CONTINUED)							
High schools offering dual enrollment	38%[2016]	**48%[2024]**	+9.9 pp ▲	71%	+11.1 pp ▲	#50	[14]
AP course enrollments per 100 high-school students	13.9[2016]	**12.8[2024]**	−1.0 ▼	18.4	+1.0 ▲	#33	[14]
Calculus enrollments per 100 high-school students	3.3[2016]	**3.1[2024]**	−0.2 ▼	3.3	−1.0 ▼	#23	[14]
Physics enrollments per 100 high-school students	5.7[2016]	**7.5[2024]**	+1.8 ▲	9.4	−0.4 ▼	#29	[14]
SAT or ACT takers per 100 high-school students	13.6[2016]	**20.2[2024]**	+6.6 ▲	18.1	−2.5 ▼	#23	[14]
Students in gifted and talented programs per 100 students	4.8[2016]	**4.6[2024]**	−0.2 ▼	7.0	+0.4 ▲	#26	[14]
ENROLLMENT AND INSTITUTIONS							
Pell Grant share of undergraduates	44%	**42%[2025]**	−2.8 pp ▼	36%	−0.8 pp ▼	#6	[15]
Fall enrollment	650K	**684K[2024]**	+5.2% ▲	19.7M	−1.7% ▼	#6	[4]
Share of enrollment at public institutions	55%	**59%[2024]**	+3.9 pp ▲	73%	0.0 pp	#41	[4]
Share of enrollment at for-profit institutions	43%	**39%[2024]**	−4.1 pp ▼	5.5%	−1.2 pp ▼	#2	[4]
Share of students enrolled part-time	37%	**43%[2024]**	+6.4 pp ▲	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#14	[4]
Share of students who are graduate students	17%	**18%[2024]**	+1.0 pp ▲	17%	+2.0 pp ▲	#15	[4]
Share of students enrolled exclusively online	46%	**54%[2024]**	+8.2 pp ▲	27%	+12.1 pp ▲	#2	[4]
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY							
Research doctorates awarded	990	**1.07K[2025]**	+8.4% ▲	59K	+7.3% ▲	#19	[7]
Science & engineering research doctorates, excluding health	667	**803[2025]**	+20% ▲	44.4K	+14% ▲	#19	[7]
Share of U.S. research doctorates	1.8%	**1.8%[2025]**	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#19	[7]
Engineering research doctorates	149	**202[2025]**	+36% ▲	10.9K	+9.9% ▲	#17	[7]
Mathematics & computer science research doctorates	63	**83[2025]**	+32% ▲	5.07K	+33% ▲	#18	[7]
STEM master's degrees per research doctorate	5.1	**10.1[2025]**	+5.0 ▲	6.4	+2.1 ▲	#5	[4]
STEM share of bachelor's	14%	**17%[2025]**	+3.4 pp ▲	24%	+5.3 pp ▲	#47	[4]
Share of bachelor's in computer & information sciences	4.4%	**5.4%[2025]**	+1.0 pp ▲	6.9%	+3.7 pp ▲	#30	[4]
Share of bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	3.3%	**4.2%[2025]**	+1.0 pp ▲	6.8%	+0.7 pp ▲	#44	[4]
Share of bachelor's in mathematics & statistics	0.4%	**0.3%[2025]**	−0.2 pp ▼	1.2%	0.0 pp	#51	[4]

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ARIZONA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY (CONTINUED)							
Share of bachelor's in biological & biomedical sciences	3.7%	**5.3%**[2025]	+1.6 pp ▲	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#43	[4]
Share of bachelor's in physical sciences	0.7%	**0.7%**[2025]	0.0 pp	1.3%	−0.3 pp ▼	#47	[4]
Share of bachelor's in health professions	20%	**17%**[2025]	−3.1 pp ▼	12%	+1.1 pp ▲	#5	[4]
Share of bachelor's in business	23%	**28%**[2025]	+5.3 pp ▲	19%	−0.1 pp ▼	#3	[4]
STEM share of master's	9.1%	**15%**[2025]	+5.8 pp ▲	23%	+6.7 pp ▲	#42	[4]
Share of master's in computer & information sciences	2.7%	**7.5%**[2025]	+4.7 pp ▲	10%	+6.3 pp ▲	#29	[4]
Share of master's in engineering & eng. technology	4.2%	**4.1%**[2025]	−0.1 pp ▼	6.7%	−0.2 pp ▼	#36	[4]
Share of master's in mathematics & statistics	0.2%	**0.6%**[2025]	+0.4 pp ▲	1.3%	+0.3 pp ▲	#38	[4]
Share of master's in biological & biomedical sciences	0.7%	**1.4%**[2025]	+0.7 pp ▲	2.5%	+0.6 pp ▲	#43	[4]
Share of master's in physical sciences	0.4%	**0.3%**[2025]	−0.1 pp ▼	0.8%	−0.1 pp ▼	#47	[4]
Share of master's in health professions	16%	**16%**[2025]	+0.1 pp ▲	15%	+1.7 pp ▲	#19	[4]
Share of master's in business	31%	**22%**[2025]	−8.7 pp ▼	21%	−3.2 pp ▼	#21	[4]
STEM share of research doctorates	20%	**22%**[2025]	+2.4 pp ▲	39%	−2.2 pp ▼	#48	[4]
Share of research doctorates in computer & information sciences	1.5%	**1.8%**[2025]	+0.3 pp ▲	4.2%	+1.4 pp ▲	#41	[4]
Share of research doctorates in engineering & eng. technology	6.2%	**7.9%**[2025]	+1.8 pp ▲	14%	−1.0 pp ▼	#45	[4]
Share of research doctorates in mathematics & statistics	1.1%	**1.5%**[2025]	+0.4 pp ▲	2.4%	−0.2 pp ▼	#32	[4]
Share of research doctorates in biological & biomedical sciences	4.1%	**4.8%**[2025]	+0.6 pp ▲	10%	−1.1 pp ▼	#47	[4]
Share of research doctorates in physical sciences	5.9%	**5.0%**[2025]	−0.9 pp ▼	7.1%	−1.1 pp ▼	#40	[4]
Share of research doctorates in health professions	8.7%	**18%**[2025]	+9.1 pp ▲	12%	+3.5 pp ▲	#13	[4]
Share of research doctorates in business	22%	**12%**[2025]	−9.6 pp ▼	5.6%	+1.3 pp ▲	#4	[4]
Bachelor's degrees per 100 undergraduates	10.4	**13.9**[2025]	+3.5 ▲	12.3	+1.4 ▲	#13	[4]
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS							
First-time students from outside the U.S.	2.3%[2016]	**2.3%**[2024]	+0.1 pp ▲	3.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#30	[4]
STEM master's degrees earned by international students	1.17K	**2.58K**[2025]	2.21× ▲	117K	2.18× ▲	#15	[4]
Share of all U.S. international STEM master's degrees	2.2%	**2.2%**[2025]	0.0 pp	100%	0.0 pp	#15	[4]

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ARIZONA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
International share of undergraduate enrollment	2.5%	**1.8%**[2024]	−0.7 pp ▼	3.0%	−0.3 pp ▼	#38	[4]
International share of graduate enrollment	6.3%	**8.9%**[2024]	+2.7 pp ▲	17%	+2.8 pp ▲	#41	[4]
International share of all bachelor's	2.3%	**2.2%**[2025]	−0.1 pp ▼	4.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#43	[4]
International share of STEM bachelor's	4.1%	**5.1%**[2025]	+1.0 pp ▲	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#24	[4]
International share of all master's	8.5%	**9.4%**[2025]	+0.9 pp ▲	22%	+6.2 pp ▲	#39	[4]
International share of STEM master's	46%	**41%**[2025]	−5.1 pp ▼	52%	+9.1 pp ▲	#27	[4]
International share of computer & information sciences master's	45%	**46%**[2025]	+1.0 pp ▲	65%	+10.1 pp ▲	#34	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology master's	63%	**52%**[2025]	−11.6 pp ▼	50%	+0.9 pp ▲	#13	[4]
International share of mathematics & statistics master's	21%	**32%**[2025]	+11.3 pp ▲	55%	+6.1 pp ▲	#26	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences master's	4.9%	**10%**[2025]	+5.4 pp ▲	23%	+6.2 pp ▲	#42	[4]
International share of physical sciences master's	17%	**23%**[2025]	+5.6 pp ▲	33%	+3.6 pp ▲	#36	[4]
International share of all research doctorates	16%	**14%**[2025]	−1.3 pp ▼	25%	−1.0 pp ▼	#46	[4]
International share of STEM research doctorates	45%	**42%**[2025]	−2.9 pp ▼	43%	−0.5 pp ▼	#25	[4]
International share of computer & information sciences research doctorates	86%	**55%**[2025]	−31.6 pp ▼	56%	+2.0 pp ▲	#17	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology research doctorates	59%	**59%**[2025]	−0.2 pp ▼	55%	−1.0 pp ▼	#18	[4]
International share of mathematics & statistics research doctorates	30%[2017]	**37%**[2025]	+6.3 pp ▲	53%	+3.9 pp ▲	#24	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences research doctorates	29%	**21%**[2025]	−8.1 pp ▼	23%	−4.3 pp ▼	#28	[4]
International share of physical sciences research doctorates	41%	**33%**[2025]	−8.6 pp ▼	38%	−1.1 pp ▼	#29	[4]
Active F-1/M-1 students, all levels	20.8K	**26.5K**[2026]	+27% ▲	1.19M	−0.1% ▼	#15	[20]
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	1.7%	**2.2%**[2026]	+0.5 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#15	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from India	17%	**42%**[2026]	+24.2 pp ▲	27%	+11.4 pp ▲	#7	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from China	37%	**13%**[2026]	−23.8 pp ▼	18%	−11.7 pp ▼	#20	[20]
Share from the two largest countries of origin	54%	**54%**[2026]	+0.4 pp ▲	45%	−0.3 pp ▼	#10	[20]

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ARIZONA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
Countries of citizenship represented	159	**169**[2026]	+6.3% ▲	219	−2.7% ▼	#22	[20]
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students	8.82K	**16.2K**[2026]	+84% ▲	749K	+61% ▲	#16	[20]
Active STEM master's students	3.53K	**8.39K**[2026]	2.38× ▲	393K	+90% ▲	#16	[20]
Active STEM doctoral students	1.71K	**2.69K**[2026]	+57% ▲	158K	+61% ▲	#18	[20]
Share of STEM master's students from India	76%	**69%**[2026]	−7.4 pp ▼	58%	−1.8 pp ▼	#8	[20]
U.S. students studying abroad for credit, from the state's institutions	5.21K[2017]	**5.57K**[2024]	+7.0% ▲	–	–	#20	[1]
Economic contribution of international students	$728M[2018]	**$1B**[2024]	+37% ▲	$42.9B	+4.6% ▲	#11	[2]
Jobs supported by international students' spending	8.74K[2018]	**8.65K**[2024]	−1.0% ▼	356K	−22% ▼	#12	[2]
Share of U.S. student and exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	1.2%	**2.0%**[2024]	+0.8 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#11	[16]
Share of U.S. F-1 student admissions, by destination	1.2%	**2.2%**[2024]	+0.9 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#11	[16]
Share of U.S. J-1 exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	1.0%	**1.4%**[2024]	+0.4 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#21	[16]
J-1 exchange visitors starting a program in the state	3.96K	**2.69K**[2025]	−32% ▼	275K	−14% ▼	#31	[18]
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH							
Graduate students in science & engineering	10.5K	**10.7K**[2016]	+1.9% ▲	620K	+0.4% ▲	#19	[9]
S&E graduate students on temporary visas	4.2K	**4.2K**[2016]	+0.0% ▲	241K	+2.3% ▲	#18	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E graduate students	40%	**39%**[2016]	−0.7 pp ▼	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#16	[9]
Temporary-visa share of engineering graduate students	61%	**58%**[2016]	−3.1 pp ▼	57%	0.0 pp	#18	[9]
S&E postdoctoral appointees	685	**659**[2016]	−3.8% ▼	45.7K	+1.0% ▲	#21	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E postdocs	47%	**49%**[2016]	+1.7 pp ▲	56%	−0.9 pp ▼	#34	[9]
University R&D spending	$1.1B	**$2.12B**[2024]	+92% ▲	$118B	+71% ▲	#19	[6]
Share of U.S. university R&D	1.6%	**1.8%**[2024]	+0.2 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#19	[6]
Federally funded share of university R&D	44%	**44%**[2024]	−0.1 pp ▼	55%	−0.2 pp ▼	#45	[6]
Business-funded share of university R&D	2.8%	**2.3%**[2024]	−0.4 pp ▼	5.4%	−0.4 pp ▼	#39	[6]
State- and locally funded share of university R&D	4.3%	**8.0%**[2024]	+3.7 pp ▲	5.2%	−0.4 pp ▼	#14	[6]
University R&D in mathematics and computer science	$31.8M	**$85.8M**[2024]	2.70× ▲	$5.12B	+97% ▲	#16	[6]

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ARIZONA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH (CONTINUED)							
University R&D in engineering	$175M	**$409M[2024]**	2.34× ▲	$19.3B	+74% ▲	#17	[6]
University R&D personnel, headcount	18.6K	**22.6K[2024]**	+21% ▲	1.09M	+20% ▲	#17	[6]
Federal R&D obligations to the state	$1.64B	**$2.35B[2024]**	+43% ▲	$193B	+53% ▲	#23	[8]
Federal R&D obligations to universities in the state	$341M	**$557M[2024]**	+63% ▲	$44.4B	+64% ▲	#24	[8]
Defense R&D obligations to the state	$1.2B	**$1.46B[2024]**	+22% ▲	$97.2B	+60% ▲	#14	[8]
Health (HHS/NIH) R&D obligations to the state	$162M	**$394M[2024]**	2.44× ▲	$48.5B	+62% ▲	#25	[8]
NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science grants performed in the state	$319M	**$680M[2025]**	2.13× ▲	$45B	+47% ▲	#21	[19]
Federal R&D contracts performed in the state	$671M	**$1.5B[2026]**	2.24× ▲	$59.3B	+59% ▲	#11	[19]
COLLEGE COSTS AND OUTCOMES							
Median earnings 10 years after entering college	$41.5K[2020]	**$51.7K[2022]**	+25% ▲	$47.5K	+11% ▲	#14	[15]
Median earnings 1 year after completing	–	**$51.5K[2025]**	–	$47.5K	–	#11	[15]
Median debt of completers	$20K	**$19.2K[2024]**	−4.2% ▼	$17.6K	−4.6% ▼	#27	[15]
STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$65K[2025]**	–	$68.2K	–	#36	[15]
Non-STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$54.4K[2025]**	–	$51.9K	–	#16	[15]
Bachelor's graduates: median earnings 5 years out	–	**$68.1K[2025]**	–	$68.1K	–	#19	[15]
STEM master's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$94.9K[2025]**	–	$91.6K	–	#15	[15]
Six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions	51%	**58%[2024]**	+7.6 pp ▲	65%	+5.3 pp ▲	#37	[4]
Completion within 150% of normal time, 2-year institutions	31%	**47%[2024]**	+15.9 pp ▲	41%	+12.1 pp ▲	#11	[4]
In-state tuition & fees, public 4-year	$13.5K	**$10K[2023]**	−26% ▼	$9.71K	−14% ▼	#26	[4]
State & local appropriations per FTE, public institutions	$9.46K	**$9.12K[2024]**	−3.6% ▼	$11.4K	+22% ▲	#37	[4]
Tuition share of core revenue, public institutions	55%	**59%[2024]**	+3.4 pp ▲	43%	−5.9 pp ▼	#10	[4]
Average full-time faculty salary (9/10-month)	$109K[2016]	**$102K[2024]**	−6.5% ▼	$106K	−4.6% ▼	#18	[4]
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO							
International graduates on OPT working in the state where they studied	37%	**38%[2016]**	+0.5 pp ▲	44%	−1.8 pp ▼	#21	[21]
OPT retention, bachelor's graduates	65%	**67%[2016]**	+1.7 pp ▲	58%	+0.3 pp ▲	#10	[21]

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ARIZONA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO (CONTINUED)							
OPT retention, master's graduates	34%	**33%**[2016]	−1.0 pp ▼	39%	−2.5 pp ▼	#26	[21]
OPT retention, STEM graduates	33%	**33%**[2016]	−0.3 pp ▼	37%	−1.9 pp ▼	#20	[21]
OPT workers employed in the state per OPT graduate of its schools	0.63	**0.70**[2016]	+0.1 ▲	1.00	0.0	#32	[21]
STEM OPT extensions approved, by state of the school	611	**878**[2016]	+44% ▲	41.2K	+51% ▲	#14	[21]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year after graduating (PSEO)	67%[2016]	**65%**[2019]	−2.2 pp ▼	72%	−0.1 pp ▼	#19	[11]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 5 years after graduating (PSEO)	–	**59%**[2016]	–	65%	–	#21	[11]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 10 years after graduating (PSEO)	–	**59%**[2010]	–	64%	–	#19	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	69%[2016]	**69%**[2019]	−0.3 pp ▼	67%	+1.5 pp ▲	#9	[11]
Master's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**52%**[2016]	–	66%	–	#29	[11]
Doctoral graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**53%**[2016]	–	49%	–	#7	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	$46.7K[2016]	**$48.6K**[2019]	+4.0% ▲	$48.1K	+2.3% ▲	#15	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 5 years out (PSEO)	–	**$68.5K**[2016]	–	$67.3K	–	#9	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	$57.5K[2016]	**$57.8K**[2019]	+0.5% ▲	$59.3K	+0.1% ▲	#18	[11]
Net domestic migration of bachelor's-plus adults, per 1,000 residents	+14.0	**+8.3**[2025]	−5.7 ▼	–	–	#7	[12]
Net domestic migration of graduate-degree holders	+3.6K	**+1.41K**[2025]	−61% ▼	–	–	#15	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved in from another state	4.9%	**4.0%**[2025]	−0.9 pp ▼	–	–	#8	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved out to another state	3.5%	**3.2%**[2025]	−0.4 pp ▼	–	–	#14	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who arrived from abroad in the past year	12.3K	**12.5K**[2025]	+2.3% ▲	–	–	#15	[12]
First-time students who are in-state residents	69%[2016]	**61%**[2024]	−7.4 pp ▼	–	–	#38	[4]
Net student migration (per 100 resident first-time students)	+26[2016]	**+37**[2024]	+11.6 ▲	–	–	#6	[4]
Recent high school graduates who go to college out of state	12%[2016]	**15%**[2022]	+2.8 pp ▲	22%	+2.5 pp ▲	#37	[3]
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS							
Certified H-1B positions, by worksite	20K	**12.4K**[2025]	−38% ▼	914K	−24% ▼	#15	[17]

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ARIZONA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS (CONTINUED)							
Share of U.S. certified H-1B positions	1.7%	**1.4%**^{2025}	−0.3 pp ▼	100%	0.0 pp	#15	[17]
STEM share of certified H-1B positions	92%	**82%**^{2025}	−10.3 pp ▼	76%	−7.8 pp ▼	#9	[17]
Median offered H-1B wage, nominal dollars	$70.6K	**$106K**^{2025}	+50% ▲	$119K	+66% ▲	#21	[17]
H-1B positions at H-1B-dependent employers	67%	**27%**^{2025}	−40.4 pp ▼	22%	−25.7 pp ▼	#10	[17]
Green-card labor certifications	806	**1.68K**^{2025}	2.08× ▲	138K	+75% ▲	#18	[17]
Share of PERM certifications for citizens of India	60%	**51%**^{2024}	−8.9 pp ▼	47%	−10.6 pp ▼	#11	[17]
PERM certifications for workers on F-1 student visas	6.0%	**11%**^{2024}	+4.8 pp ▲	8.7%	+4.9 pp ▲	#21	[17]
PERM workers with a master's or doctorate	57%	**49%**^{2024}	−7.7 pp ▼	47%	−4.9 pp ▼	#12	[17]
STEM share of PERM certifications	72%	**60%**^{2025}	−12.7 pp ▼	49%	−25.8 pp ▼	#8	[17]
Median offered PERM wage, nominal dollars	$81.6K	**$101K**^{2025}	+24% ▲	$100K	+9.9% ▲	#12	[17]
New lawful permanent residents (green cards), by state of residence	18K	**24.9K**^{2024}	+38% ▲	1.36M	+30% ▲	#14	[16]
Share of U.S. new green-card holders	1.7%	**1.8%**^{2024}	+0.1 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#14	[16]
People naturalized as U.S. citizens, by state of residence	13.7K	**14.2K**^{2024}	+3.4% ▲	819K	+12% ▲	#15	[16]
Share of U.S. naturalizations	1.9%	**1.7%**^{2024}	−0.1 pp ▼	100%	0.0 pp	#15	[16]
Share of U.S. temporary-worker admissions, by destination	2.2%	**8.0%**^{2024}	+5.8 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#4	[16]
Share of U.S. H-1B worker admissions, by destination	1.1%	**1.5%**^{2024}	+0.4 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#14	[16]
Share of U.S. L-1 intracompany-transferee admissions, by destination	0.9%	**1.7%**^{2024}	+0.7 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#14	[16]
Share of U.S. O-1 extraordinary-ability worker admissions, by destination	0.3%	**0.7%**^{2024}	+0.3 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#19	[16]
New H-1B approvals (initial), by employer state	712	**1.66K**^{2026}	2.34× ▲	127K	+14% ▲	#16	[13]
Continuing H-1B approvals, by employer state	1.12K	**3.15K**^{2026}	2.81× ▲	268K	+52% ▲	#19	[13]
Share of U.S. new H-1B approvals	0.6%	**1.3%**^{2026}	+0.7 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#16	[13]
Denial rate, new H-1B petitions	6.8%	**2.5%**^{2026}	−4.3 pp ▼	3.4%	−3.0 pp ▼	#44	[13]
New H-1B approvals at colleges and schools (NAICS 61)	26%	**14%**^{2026}	−12.1 pp ▼	8.6%	−1.7 pp ▼	#29	[13]
New H-1B approvals in professional, scientific & technical services	30%	**27%**^{2026}	−3.7 pp ▼	44%	−12.5 pp ▼	#27	[13]

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ARIZONA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS (CONTINUED)							
Five largest employers' share of new H-1B approvals	30%	**27%**[2026]	−3.1 pp ▼	9.1%	−6.7 pp ▼	#33	[13]
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION							
Workers in STEM occupations	168K	**283K**[2024]	+68% ▲	13.7M	+51% ▲	#17	[12]
STEM workers as a share of all workers	5.7%	**7.8%**[2024]	+2.1 pp ▲	8.1%	+2.1 pp ▲	#21	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers	18%	**20%**[2024]	+2.9 pp ▲	24%	+1.6 pp ▲	#14	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers with a graduate degree	35%	**39%**[2024]	+4.0 pp ▲	41%	+2.2 pp ▲	#11	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers with a doctorate	39%[2019]	**53%**[2024]	+14.0 pp ▲	47%	+0.9 pp ▲	#6	[12]
Noncitizen share of STEM workers	9.3%	**9.7%**[2024]	+0.4 pp ▲	11%	+0.7 pp ▲	#13	[12]
STEM workers born abroad who arrived in the last 10 years	5.2%	**7.5%**[2024]	+2.3 pp ▲	7.5%	+0.3 pp ▲	#10	[12]
Share of foreign-born STEM workers born in India	33%	**26%**[2024]	−7.6 pp ▼	28%	+0.7 pp ▲	#20	[12]
Foreign-born share of residents	13%	**13%**[2025]	−0.2 pp ▼	15%	+1.3 pp ▲	#16	[12]
Foreign-born share of graduate-degree holders, 25+	16%	**18%**[2025]	+2.7 pp ▲	21%	+2.8 pp ▲	#16	[12]
STEM jobs, employer survey	168K	**203K**[2025]	+20% ▲	10.4M	+26% ▲	#18	[10]
STEM jobs concentration vs the U.S., location quotient	1.09	**0.94**[2025]	−0.2 ▼	1.00	0.0	#21	[10]
Mean annual STEM wage, nominal	$81.1K	**$112K**[2025]	+38% ▲	$120K	+38% ▲	#19	[10]
Median software developer wage, nominal	$99.3K[2019]	**$130K**[2025]	+31% ▲	$136K	+26% ▲	#22	[10]
Software developer jobs	24.6K	**38K**[2025]	+55% ▲	1.69M	+48% ▲	#16	[10]
Mean annual wage, all occupations, nominal	$45.3K	**$67.6K**[2025]	+49% ▲	$69.8K	+44% ▲	#20	[10]
Patents granted to assignees in the state	1.2K	**1.78K**[2025]	+49% ▲	135K	−0.6% ▼	#20	[22]
Share of U.S.-assignee patents	0.9%	**1.3%**[2025]	+0.4 pp ▲	100%	0.0 pp	#20	[22]
Share of the state's patents in digital technologies	27%	**28%**[2025]	+0.9 pp ▲	43%	+1.6 pp ▲	#18	[22]
Share of the state's patents in life sciences	15%	**14%**[2025]	−1.2 pp ▼	17%	+0.4 pp ▲	#33	[22]
Share of the state's patents in semiconductors	15%	**9.7%**[2025]	−5.6 pp ▼	2.9%	−1.7 pp ▼	#2	[22]
Women's share of inventors on the state's patents	7.3%	**11%**[2025]	+4.2 pp ▲	14%	+3.4 pp ▲	#26	[22]

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